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Airbnb as a tool for business promotion: creating a strategy for Massovka

BACHELOR THESIS

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Prohlášení

Prohlašuji, že jsem bakalářskou práci Airbnb as a tool for business promotion: creating a strategy for Massovka vypracovala samostatně za použití v práci uvedených pramenů a literatury.

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Abstrakt

Tato bakalářská práce zkoumá potenciál využití platformy Airbnb Experiences jako nástroje digitálního marketingu pro propagaci kreativních workshopů. Zaměřuje se na případ Massovky, uměleckého studia se sídlem v Praze. Hlavním cílem je vytvořit a validovat marketingovou strategii, která Massovce pomůže přilákat nový segment zákazníků prostřednictvím Airbnb. Současně práce hodnotí, jak mohou funkce této platformy podpořit zapojení zákazníků a růst podnikání. Výzkum kombinuje teoretickou analýzu marketingových modelů s kvalitativním výzkumem. Ten zahrnuje rozhovory se zákazníky Massovky, uživateli Airbnb a potenciálními místními klienty. K posouzení vnitřního a vnějšího prostředí Massovky jsou využity analytické nástroje, jako je SWOT analýza a matice IFE/EFE. Pro hodnocení Airbnb jako nástroje propagace služeb ve srovnání s dalšími klíčovými hráči v oblasti cestování a zážitků je použita percepční mapa. Na základě zjištěných poznatků je vytvořena marketingová strategie podle modelu STDC. Strategie se zaměřuje na propagaci workshopů zaměřených na výrobu sladkostí jako vstupního bodu na platformu Airbnb Experiences. Odborné hodnocení potvrdilo praktickou použitelnost navržené strategie. Vyzdvihlo její soulad s hodnotami značky Massovka a se vzorci chování publika Airbnb. Výsledky ukazují, že integrace s Airbnb nabízí Massovce realistickou a udržitelnou cestu k růstu zákaznické základny. To však platí za předpokladu, že budou aktivně řízeny počáteční výzvy v oblasti zapojení. Tato práce přispívá k lepšímu pochopení, jak mohou kreativní podniky přizpůsobit digitální platformy, které tradičně spojované s cestovním ruchem, pro posílení své tržní pozice.

Klíčová slova

Digitální marketing, marketingová strategie, Airbnb, zážitkový marketing, kreativní průmysl.

JEL klasifikace

M31

Abstract

This bachelor thesis explores the potential of using Airbnb Experiences as a digital marketing tool for promoting creative workshops, focusing on the case of Massovka, an art studio based in Prague. The main aim is to develop a marketing strategy to help Massovka attract a new segment of customers through Airbnb and to evaluate how the platform's features could support customer engagement and business growth. The research combines theoretical analysis of marketing models with qualitative research, including interviews with Massovka's customers, Airbnb users and potential local clients. Analytical tools such as SWOT, IFE/EFE matrices are used to assess Massovka's internal and external environment. A perceptual map is used to evaluate Airbnb as a tool for promoting services in comparison to other key players in the travel and experience industry. Based on the findings, a marketing strategy is created using the STDC model, focusing on promoting sweets workshops as an entry point to Airbnb Experiences. Expert evaluation confirms the strategy's practical applicability, highlighting its alignment with Massovka's brand values and the behavioural patterns of Airbnb's audience. The results show that Airbnb integration offers Massovka a realistic and sustainable path for customer growth, provided that early engagement challenges are actively managed. This thesis contributes to a better understanding how creative businesses can adapt digital platforms traditionally associated with tourism to strengthen their market position.

Keywords

Digital marketing, marketing strategy, Airbnb, experience marketing, creative industry.

JEL Classification

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Introduction

Defining the topic and justifying the choice

The choice of this topic is based on the intention to explore new marketing opportunities by using the Airbnb platform. Airbnb is traditionally associated with accommodation services, and hosts not only the properties of landlords but also local experiences to promote small businesses on the platform since 2016 (Airbnb, 2019). In a highly competitive environment among traditional marketing channels that are often oversaturated, it is important to look for non-standard solutions that can differentiate a company from others. Airbnb offers a platform focused on unique experiences, which opens up the prospect for Massovka to promote its workshops to a broader audience looking for experiences. By exploring this topic, a new strategy is developed to demonstrate how Airbnb platform can be utilized to attract customers and strengthen the company's position in the creative services market.

Research objectives and tasks

The main objective of this bachelor thesis is to create and validate a marketing strategy to promote Massovka's creative workshops through the Airbnb Experiences platform. To achieve this goal, the following sub-objectives are defined:

- to study the fundamentals of marketing and digital marketing, with a focus on their application to online service platforms such as Airbnb;
- to analyze the functionality of the Airbnb platform, including its user engagement methods and service listing requirements;
- to research Massovka's brand positioning, workshop offerings and target audience characteristics;
- to develop a marketing strategy tailored to the platform's audience, using appropriate digital marketing frameworks;
- to evaluate the potential customer engagement and practical feasibility of the proposed strategy through qualitative research and expert evaluation.

The developed strategy is designed to align with the needs of Massovka's target audience, the specifics of its workshops and the platform environment of Airbnb, ensuring relevance to real market conditions. This thesis offers a ready to implement marketing solution and serves as a foundation for expanding the use of Airbnb Experiences for promoting creative services.

Research structure and data collection methods

The bachelor thesis is divided into two main parts: a theoretical part and a practical part.

The theoretical part is based on literature review and secondary data. It introduces essential marketing concepts and strategic tools, including segmentation, SWOT analysis, IFE and EFE matrices and the STDC model. It also explores the specifics of experience marketing within the creative industry and the features of the Airbnb Experiences platform, including platform rules, target audience and competitors' overview.

The practical part combines both analytical and qualitative research components. First, it presents an internal and external evaluation of the Massovka studio using interviews with the co-owner, SWOT, IFE/EFE matrices and a perceptual map to assess strategic fit with Airbnb. Second, it includes qualitative research based on nine in-depth interviews across three audience segments (Massovka clients, Airbnb users and local prospects), aiming to uncover key emotional triggers, barriers and communication preferences. These findings are then used to define strategic goals, formulate a communication insight and develop a marketing strategy tailored to the Airbnb platform using the STDC framework. The work concludes with an expert evaluation of the strategy by marketing professionals and Massovka's co-owner to confirm its practical applicability and the achievement of the stated objectives.

Research question

The research question guiding this bachelor thesis is:

How does the integration of Airbnb's platform features influence customer engagement and business growth for Massovka's creative workshops?

In this thesis, customer engagement is measured through Airbnb specific metrics such as profile views, listing clicks, wishlist saves and direct interactions with the host. This question is designed to focus the theoretical exploration, analytical evaluation and practical strategy development presented in the thesis. It reflects the intention to understand not only the technical use of the platform but also its emotional and strategic relevance for a creative business aiming to expand its customer base through non-traditional marketing channels.

1 Theoretical part

This chapter provides the theoretical foundation for developing a digital marketing strategy to promote creative experiences via the Airbnb platform, with specific application to the Massovka art studio. It begins by introducing the evolution of marketing from traditional to digital models, highlighting tools and frameworks relevant to online service promotion. The chapter further explores the characteristics of experience-based marketing in the creative industry, defining the context in which Massovka operates. The final part presents an overview of Airbnb as a service-based digital platform, analyzing its marketing relevance and requirements. These combined perspectives support the strategy development in later chapters.

1.1 Definition of marketing

Marketing is a diverse and wide-ranging field described in numerous books and articles that present various definitions of the term.

Many people believe that marketing is reduced to advertising and sales, but Kotler and McDougall (1985) define it as a complex activity that includes identifying consumer needs, creating appropriate goods and services, setting prices and organizing their distribution and promotion. At the same time, sales and advertising are important, but not the only components of marketing.

Peter Drucker emphasizes that the main goal of marketing is to achieve such an understanding and satisfaction of customer needs that the product or service will “sell itself” (Drucker, 1974). The interesting point of view was suggested by Jitka (2022), she claims that marketing should not only satisfy but also generate customer needs.

It is certain that marketing is a highly effective tool that can help business owners attract more customers. Nowadays, marketing is not only aimed at satisfying consumer needs but also at retaining customers.

1.2 STP marketing

Traditional marketing usually starts with market segmentation, which is the process of dividing customers into smaller groups based on certain characteristics. The criteria for division can be geographic and demographic data, psychographic and behavioural characteristics. After segmentation comes targeting, where one or more of the most promising segments are selected. This allows the firm's resources to be focused on those groups that are most likely to bring profit. Then comes the brand positioning stage, which

aims to create a unique image or perception of the product in the target audience (Karlíček & Kolektiv, 2018).

Overall, the STP model enhances marketing strategy by prioritizing customers over products. It helps firms identify ideal customers and tailor marketing to their preferences, boosting long-term success and profitability.

1.3 Digital marketing

Nowadays, marketing is divided into offline and online, the second one being closely related to the development of the internet (Jitka, 2022). Companies can interact with customers remotely using a variety of channels, but this presents several challenges, which will be discussed in this chapter.

1.3.1 Moving from traditional to digital marketing

In the previously mentioned STP method, segmentation and targeting are usually done by marketers in a one-sided manner, without taking into account the customers' opinions. Such actions can be perceived by customers as intrusive, violating personal space and causing irritation (Kotler et al., 2016). The concept of “permission marketing” appears in response, the essence of which is to obtain customers' permission to receive marketing messages (Godin, 1999). Brand positioning becomes key as customers easily and thoroughly research and evaluate brands in the digital economy. Changing technologies, shortening product life cycles and dynamically changing trends require brands to be flexible and actively manage their reputation (Kotler et al., 2016).

1.3.2 Commercialization theory of the Four C's

Kotler et al. (2016) and Janouch (2020) claim that online marketing is similar to traditional marketing and that both should work together to strengthen the interaction between customers and companies.

In today's interconnected world, the concept of marketing mix is evolving. The classic theory of the Four P's (*product, place, price, promotion*) used to plan what to offer to consumers and how, is being replaced by the concept of the Four C's (*co-creation, currency, communal activation and conversation*) that allows consumers to be more involved in the entire marketing process (Kotler et al., 2016).

The product or service is now not only designed based on the consumer's needs, but also personalized to the consumer, creating the greatest value (Figure 1). The price of a product or service is not only calculated on costs, competition and customer interests, but like a “currency” varies depending on different customer-centric aspects: purchase history, store location, time spent studying the product instructions and others. “Peer-to-peer distribution” makes it easier for customers to access goods or services. Delivery systems, support services and self-delivery are developing, which is the essence of social activism.

The promotion of a product or service becomes a dialogue with the customer, its discussion with other consumers (Kotler et al., 2016).

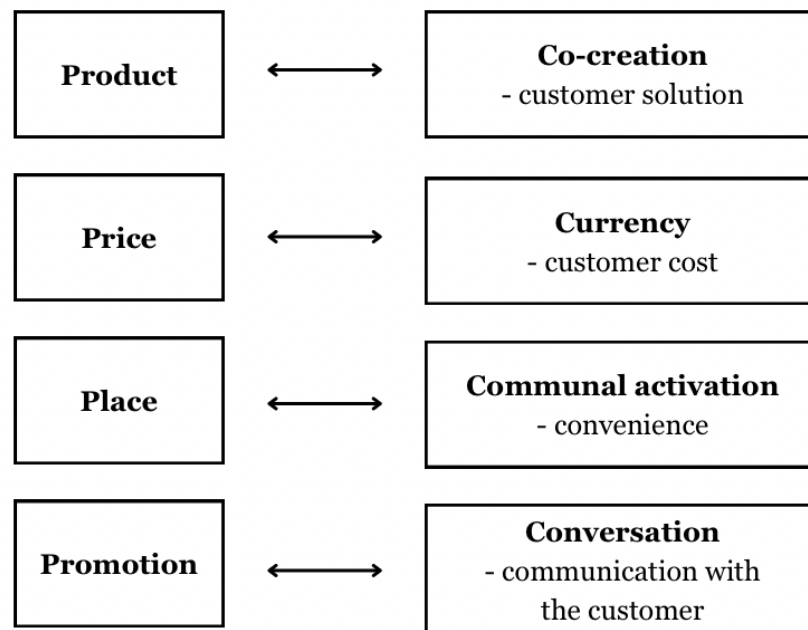


Figure 1. From selling the Four P's to commercialising the Four C's (source: Kotler et al., 2016, own processing)

To summarize, nowadays companies and consumers work together to achieve their goals: companies seek to increase profits, while customers aim to maximize their satisfaction with products and services.

1.4 Digital marketing strategy

Any advertising on the internet or on television is commonly thought of as marketing, whereas such advertising is only part of an extensive and structured marketing strategy.

According to Kotler and Armstrong (2020) marketing strategy is a structure that aims to create customer value and achieve effective communication with the consumer. Jitka (2022) identifies the following key steps in creating a marketing strategy in the digital age:

- Information gathering
- Data analysis
- Goal setting
- Segmentation
- Strategy development
- Strategy Implementation, Monitoring and Feedback

This bachelor's thesis will emphasize the first five elements of marketing strategy, from information gathering to strategy development, as the purpose of the paper is not to put the

created strategy into practice, but only to evaluate its feasibility and effectiveness by the experts.

It is essential to combine traditional and digital marketing tools to develop a reliable marketing strategy for Massovka's integration with Airbnb. This section presents a comprehensive set of models used throughout the thesis. First, data collection and situational analysis frameworks (SWOT, IFE, EFE, IE) are introduced. These are followed by strategy planning tools, including SMART goals and customer segmentation (STP), which together form the final strategic communications model (STDC) used in the practical part.

1.4.1 Information gathering

The development of a new strategy always starts with collecting the necessary information. This can be gathered internally within the company (microenvironment): data about customers, services provided, competitors, sales statistics and everything else the company can influence. It can also be collected from external sources (macroenvironment): information about politics, culture, economy, society, geographical data, those that the firm cannot influence by its existence (Jitka, 2022).

If information is lacking, marketing research is conducted. This research involves collecting, processing and analysing primary and secondary data. Primary data are collected directly from the source via surveys, such as interviews with the owner of the company or their customers. They are original, new to the marketer. On the other hand, secondary data are already gathered, and their sources may come from the official statistical websites, newspapers, the internet or official organizations that provide public data (Karlíček & Kolektiv, 2018).

In this thesis, the main focus will be on the companies' microenvironment. This information is necessary for analyzing its current market position among competitors and allows for forming a sustainable and effective strategy for the future. The data about Airbnb platform will be collected through secondary research, including information from the official website, statistical data and academic journals. Meanwhile, data about Massovka company will be gathered through in-depth conversations with its owner and their customers by qualitative primary research.

1.4.2 Data analysis

The following step in developing a successful marketing strategy is the analysis of collected data. Kotler and Armstrong (2020) term this type of analysis as situational, which helps to determine the company's current position in the market and identify factors that can influence its success.

SWOT analysis

In this bachelor's thesis, the process of data analysis is conducted using the SWOT method. It evaluates the company's *strengths* (S), *weaknesses* (W), *opportunities* (O) and *threats*

(T). The first two aspects of this method are influenced by the internal factors of the company: strengths differentiate the business from its competitors, while weaknesses indicate the company's vulnerabilities and its negative factors (Karlíček & Kolektiv, 2018). The last two aspects are related to external factors that the company faces and which marketers are not able to influence: opportunities are favorable factors that the company can use to its advantage, while the threats are unfavorable factors that could lead to potential losses in profit or reduced productivity (Kotler & Armstrong, 2020).

A mutual assessment is conducted after organizing the information into four parts. For example, comparing the company's weaknesses with its opportunities might reveal how an opportunity can turn a weakness into a strength. Similarly, analyzing strengths against threats may show how a threat could introduce a new weakness. These evaluations help the company determine where to maintain focus and what changes to consider (Jitka, 2022).

It can be noted that SWOT analysis provides an excellent foundation for determining the marketing objectives of a company, as it considers various aspects that affect its development.

Evaluation of Internal and External factors

The IE (Internal-External) matrix is one of the tools for creating a marketing strategy. It evaluates the factors gathered from the SWOT analysis, presented in the form of IFE (Internal Factor Evaluation) and EFE (External Factor Evaluation) matrices. The IFE matrix assesses the strengths and weaknesses of the company. This helps better understand which internal resources can be used to achieve strategic goals or need improvement. The EFE matrix measures how the company can leverage opportunities and minimize threats, helping to identify key external factors for strategy development (Jiří et al., 2020).

The data from both matrices are plotted on the x and y axes of the IE matrix, which is divided into nine quadrants (Figure 2). Cells I, II и IV suggest a “build and develop” strategy and could be characterized as an intensive strategy that involves market penetration, market development and product development. Quadrants III, V и VII represent a “hold and maintain” strategy, where the two most popular tactics in this division are product development and market penetration. The remaining quadrants offer "harvest or divest" tactics along with suggested defenses and potential escape routes (Budiono, 2017).

		BUSINESS STRENGTH/ COMPETITIVE POSITION <i>Internal factor evaluation</i>			
		STRONG	AVERAGE	WEAK	
INDUSTRY ATTRACTIVENESS <i>External factor evaluation</i>	HIGH	I grow and build	II grow and build	III hold and maintain	4
	MEDIUM	IV grow and build	V hold and maintain	VI harvest or divest	3
	LOW	VII hold and maintain	VIII harvest or divest	IX harvest or divest	2
		4	3	2	1

Figure 2. IE matrix (source: Francis, 2024, own processing)

Within the framework of this bachelor's research, the IE is used to assess Massovka company's market position and determine the most suitable development strategy focusing on either growth or stabilization, based on its current standing in the matrix.

Perceptual map

Some marketers use the perceptual map as a tool to determine a positioning of a brand on the market. The graph displays the image of some competing brands based on selected characteristics. As an example, it might be the ratio of quality and price of the product (Karlíček & Kolektiv, 2018).

In this bachelor thesis, the perceptual map is used to compare Airbnb platform with its competitors in the service platform market.

1.4.3 Goal setting

The next step involves determining the marketing goals, which are based on a comprehensive data analysis. The strategy will subsequently be created depending on these goals, so their accurate definition is the most important condition for the effectiveness and success of the marketing strategy. This defines what should be achieved and when within the new strategy and serves as criteria for its expert evaluation.

Commonly used objectives in digital marketing include (Kotler & Armstrong, 2020):

- increase brand awareness or website traffic;
- improve brand or product reputation, search engine rankings;
- generate sales leads;

- reduce customer acquisition and support costs;
- increase sales.

Karlíček and Kolektiv (2018) claim that every marketing objective should be set according to the SMART criteria:

- Specific (S)
- Measurable (M)
- Achievable (A)
- Realistic (R)
- Time-bound (T)

In fact, the SMART method is commonly used among marketers. It is a universal concept that helps in planning a company's actions making sure that the outcomes are predictable and doable, which is particularly vital for entrepreneurship and marketing (Kotler & Armstrong, 2020).

In this thesis, the SMART method is also utilized to define the research objective. The aim is to develop a strategic proposal for integrating Airbnb Experience into the marketing strategy of the creative studio Massovka. This objective is:

- Specific - focused on a single marketing tool and company.
- Measurable - measured through the experts' evaluation.
- Achievable - based on existing company resources.
- Realistic - given the studio's scale and audience.
- Time-bound - to be completed within the thesis time frame.

1.4.4 Segmentation

The following step, which the marketer should focus on, is identifying the target audience. Since online marketing touches global marketing, the audience of such a market is quite extensive. Therefore, it is necessary to segment it, meaning to divide it into groups of people with different needs, behavioural patterns or distinct reactions to the marketing mix (Jitka, 2022; Kotler et al., 2007).

Jitka (2022) asserts that the company itself determines the characteristics by which it can segment the market, focusing on the product that needs to be promoted and sold. She suggests dividing the segments according to the following characteristics: demographic, geographical, cultural, socio-psychological and socio-economic.

Kotler and Armstrong (2020) narrow down the characteristics to the basic ones, naming them demographic, geographic, psychographic and behavioural (Table 1).

Segmentation base	Brief description	Consumer market features
Demographic	Answers "who" questions	Age, gender, income, occupation, marital status,

		family lifestyle, education, socio-economic status
Geographic	Answers “where” questions	Region, country, geospatial data, market size, population density, climate, environmental context (indoor or outdoor), language
Psychographic	Answers “why” questions	Motives, personality traits (openness, need for variety, impression management), values, attitudes, interests
Behavioural	Answers “how” questions	Role (buyer, user, influencer), purchase occasions, customer value, usage rate, shopping patterns (searching online, reading reviews, purchase preferences), payment patterns, media consumption

Table 1. Segmentation Bases and Variables by Market Type (source: Kotler & Armstrong, 2020, own processing)

Analyzing the transition of traditional marketing to the digital, Kotler et al. (2016) concludes that audience boundaries can be determined by the characteristics mentioned above, but the main one is consumer behaviour. They suggest focusing on specific subcultures, social groups of people with common interests who prefer to gather together and share their experiences with each other. They influence the majority opinion within their subculture.

After the marketer defines the ‘perimeter of the audience’, the process of forming its profile begins. Detailed characteristics, personal qualities, fears and desires of the audience are delineated, which helps in identifying their needs. Using this information, marketers develop a strategy aimed at reducing the audience’s fears and meeting their needs (Kotler et al., 2016).

One of the objectives of this bachelor’s thesis is to analyze the existing audiences of Airbnb and Massovka companies. It is necessary to create a profile for the audience, identify common interests between both groups and determine which audience will respond most effectively to the strategy developed in the future.

1.4.5 Strategy development

The information gathered in the previous chapters allows the building of the marketing strategy which is the main purpose of this bachelor thesis.

When creating a strategy, it is important to select methods and tools that align with both the brand's mission and the target audience's behavioural characteristics. Jitka (2022)

recommends various marketing models that assist in crafting and executing a clear marketing strategy. These include competitive strategy, brand value building strategy, customer loyalty strategy, strategy focused on sales using the AIDA model (Attention, Interest, Desire, Action), the Foote-Cone-Belding model and the STDC model (See, Think, Do, Care). Jitka (2022) particularly highlights the STDC model as an effective tool for developing a digital marketing strategy. In the case of Massovka, the STDC is especially relevant, as it offers a customer-centered approach suitable for experience-based businesses operating through digital platforms like Airbnb.

Marketing insight

An essential part of creating any strategy is the formulation of a marketing insight. An insight reflects a deep understanding of customer behaviour or emotional motivation and guides the tone, message and direction of the entire campaign. It bridges the gap between analysis and action, serving as the foundation for both creative and media strategies. One of the effective methods for insight formulation is the OUA model (Observation, Understanding, Articulation). This model starts with a key finding derived from research or customer behaviour (Observation) and continues with Understanding, which explains why this behaviour occurs and what it reveals about customer needs. The method ends with a clear and actionable expression of what the brand must say or do in response, which is Articulation (Vysoká škola ekonomická v Praze, n.d.).

In this bachelor thesis, the marketing insight will be formulated based on the research analysis and applied as a foundation for setting more precise goals and shaping the overall marketing strategy. This approach ensures that the proposed solution directly responds to the needs and motivations of the target audience.

STDC model

The STDC method was developed by Avinash Kaushik specifically for online marketing with the goal of increasing sales of the company's products and services. It focuses not only on the phase of a customer making a purchase but also on the phases before and after the purchase (Jitka, 2022).

Kaushik (2015) divides the customer journey into four main stages, where each segment of customers has different intentions and motivation for purchasing. This segmentation does not rely on demographic or social characteristics, but on customers' engagement at various stages (Figure 3).



Figure 3. See, Think, Do, Care model (source: Kaushik, 2015, own processing)

See - This phase represents the broadest group of people who could potentially be interested in a product or service. The goal for marketers in this phase is to engage with the content of the product, attract customer attention and stimulate their interest. There are various advertising channels to promote the product or service: PPC (Pay-per-click) banners, social websites, web platforms (Jitka, 2022).

Think - The second stage involves potential customers who already have an understanding of the product or service and compare it to other competitors. The marketer's task is to provide enough information about the product to convince the customer of its necessity. There are added new marketing channels such as websites and search engines. The company is focusing on the SEO optimization to facilitate the customer's information search (Jitka, 2022).

Do - Only those customers who have been convinced to purchase the product or service reach this phase. The marketers focus on a few main tasks: to shorten the buying process, making it simple and clear for the customers. Reviews from previous buyers, e-shops that reduce the purchase time and delivery system can help in this regard (Jitka, 2022).

Care - During this final phase, the company strives to care for its customers with the aim of encouraging them to make repeat purchases. To convert a customer into a regular one, the company may use email marketing, request feedback or create a loyalty card (Jitka, 2022). It is also crucial to note that the customer who has gone through all four phases becomes a loyal customer of the company and does not need to undergo the process again (Kaushik, 2015).

Since each stage of the STDC model requires unique approaches in marketing communication across the different channels, its success is measured by corresponding metrics (Figure 4) (Kaushik, 2015).

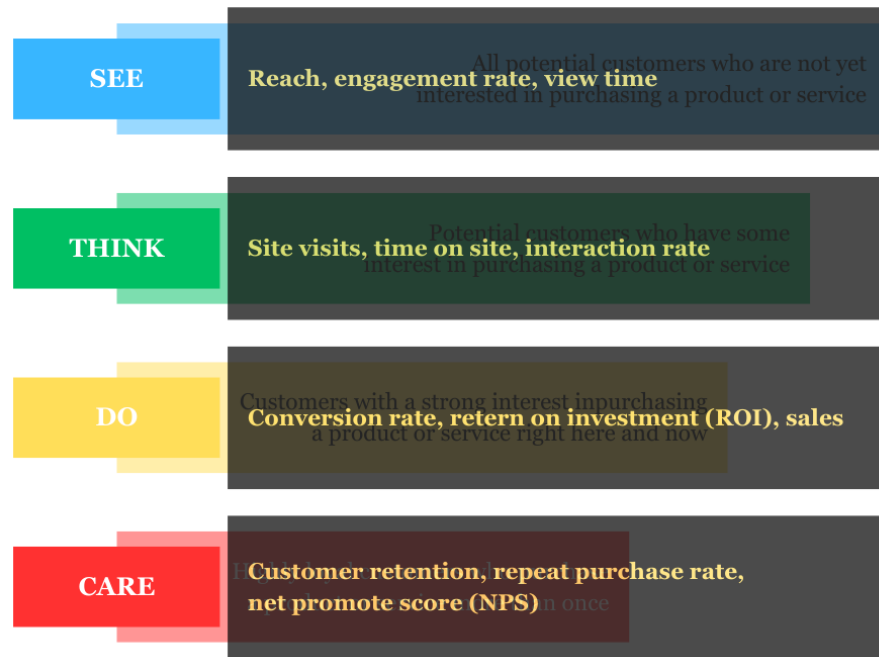


Figure 4. See, Think, Do, Care metrics (source: Kaushik, 2015, own processing)

The STDC model will be used in this bachelor's thesis as it allows Massovka to dynamically respond to customer behaviour in the future, in case the company decides to implement the developed strategy.

1.5 The concept of experience marketing in the creative industry

Massovka is a creative company focusing on running artistic and ceramic workshops. Founded in Prague in 2022 by two friends, Massovka offers a space for people to explore their creativity, participate in hands-on activities and enjoy the process of making art. Massovka fosters a friendly atmosphere where people can develop their artistic skills by providing workshops in painting and pottery (Maiska, A., personal conversation, March 2, 2025).

This paragraph of the bachelor thesis explores the concept of experience marketing and its significance in artistic businesses, focusing on the case of Massovka. Key theories of experience marketing are examined to understand how businesses like Massovka create emotionally engaging interactions for customers. The paragraph also defines the creative industry and its role in cultural and economic development and provides an overview of workshop formats within the creative sector.

1.5.1 Foundations of experience marketing

As a provider of interactive pottery and painting events, Massovka represents a creative experience-based business that goes beyond traditional art workshops by incorporating the

principles of experience marketing. This marketing approach emphasizes creating emotionally engaging and memorable interaction for consumers (Pine II and Gilmore, 1998). It is essential to explore key theories in the field of experience marketing to better understand how Massovka aligns with its concepts.

According to Pine II and Gilmore (1998), an experience occurs *“when a company intentionally uses services as the stage, and goods as props, to engage individual customers in a way that creates a memorable event”*. Their concept of the experience economy suggests that businesses which provide creative workshops do not simply offer goods or services, they organize experiences that engage customers on an emotional and sensory level.

Schmitt (1999) further argues that experience marketing has evolved to an interaction between multiple senses, such as sight, touch and sound, that in turn creates a deeper emotional connection with the consumers. This is evident in Massovka’s approach, where participants engage in visually stimulating drawing sessions, feel the tactile sensations of clay modeling and enjoy the social and immersive atmosphere of the workshops. These elements contribute to a deep personal and engaging experience for customers.

Beyond sensory engagement, experiences should evoke fantasy, feelings and fun. Hedonic consumption, which refers to consumer behaviour driven by the pursuit of pleasure, enjoyment and sensory stimulation beyond functional needs, is the main concept introduced by Holbrook and Hirschman (1982). Their research highlights that customers seek creative experiences not for practical learning but for self-expression, emotional fulfilment and relaxation. This aligns with Massovka’s positioning, as participants engage in painting and pottery workshops for self-discovery, mindfulness and creative enjoyment.

While Massovka can be positioned within several of mentioned above experience marketing models, the experience economy framework by Pine II and Gilmore (1998) provides the best fit. The four areas of experience (education, entertainment, escapism into a fantasy world and aesthetic experience) perfectly encapsulate Massovka’s offering. Customers learn new skills (education), enjoy social and interactive elements (entertainment), immerse themselves in a creative process (escapism) and create visually appealing art (aesthetic experience). Thus, Massovka thrives as an experience-based business within the experience economy, offering customers a memorable and engaging artistic journey.

1.5.2 Definition of creative industry

As a creative enterprise offering both material and non-material artistic experiences, Massovka operates within the framework of the creative industry.

Dostál et al. (2012) explain that the outcome of creative industries can be either physical items or immersive experiences, where symbolic and emotional value outweighs functional use. This emphasizes how creative industries enrich cultural experiences and add value to society beyond functionality (Dostál et al., 2012).

ESSnet-Culture (European Statistical System Network on Culture) offers a detailed definition of creative industries that the European Union accepted in October 2011 for

research. This definition includes industries like cultural heritage, archives, libraries, publishing, performing arts, audiovisual and multimedia content, architecture, advertising, crafts. These areas contribute to various economic activities such as creation, production, publishing, distribution, trading and education (Bína et al., 2012).

According to research, creative activity often gathers in specific locations, which can grow into creative clusters over time (Bagwell, 2008). De Propriis and Hypponen (2007) define creative clusters as places where people from different fields come together, connected by their shared interest in innovation and creativity. These clusters act as catalysts where ideas, skills and relationships interact, creating a diverse and open environment for self-expression. Such an environment encourages individuals to develop their unique talents and identities.

1.5.3 Workshops in the creative industry

This section of the bachelor thesis examines different types of workshops and their target audience segmentation within the creative industry.

According to the Cambridge Dictionary, a workshop is a type of event where a group of people gather to work together, learn and achieve specific goals (Cambridge University Press, n.d.).

The workshop format depends on the objectives that participants wish to achieve (Ekam.ru, 2024):

- craft or art workshop, where the primary goal is to learn craft skills. The choice of materials, instruments and execution techniques attracts attention. A ceramics workshop, which ends in the production of a completed product, is one such example.
- a creative studio. This format is suitable for photographers, artists and designers and involves the creation of artistic products: photos, paintings, design projects.
- discussion format that expects participants to discuss a chosen topic or issue. Each expresses their well-reasoned opinion and poses questions. Such workshops enhance skills in listening to the opponent, thinking outside the box and developing strategies.
- a brainstorming session format. It is known for rapidly generating a maximum number of ideas relevant to the given topic and issues. Interaction is formed based on each participant's openness to unconventional ideas and creative problem-solving approach.
- a competition format is used in the business environment where participants present innovative ideas, compete with each other and are evaluated by a jury.
- a marathon format involves prolonged engagement with complex tasks, developing endurance and stress resilience. This format allows participants to unlock their creative potential and undergo a test of durability.

It is believed that the target audience for workshops is divided into professionals, who share experience, and beginners, who learn new skills from experts. There is no necessity to

separate the participants into distinct groups based on skill level, they rather can be integrated to generate more unique ideas during the workshop. This approach encourages mutual learning: beginners gain knowledge and techniques from experienced individuals, while professionals receive valuable feedback and different perspectives on their activities (Ekam.ru, 2024).

Thus, Massovka aligns with both the art workshop and creative studio formats. Particularly in ceramics, where participants use materials, tools, and techniques to produce a complete product, it focusses on teaching craft skills. At the same time, it provides an artistic space for creative expression, which is similar to a creative studio, where people can explore painting and other kinds of visual art.

1.6 The role of Airbnb platform in marketing unique experiences

Since 2008, Airbnb has been a platform that links hosts and guests from all over the world. Because Airbnb only receives a commission upon a successful transaction, listing a property on this site is totally free, protecting both the host and the guest (Airbnb, 2025a):

- profile verification and listing review.
- a reliable messaging system for hosts and guests.
- a secure payment platform.

Airbnb Experiences, a category that enables local hosts to develop and promote creative, cultural or lifestyle events, provides carefully planned activities in addition to accommodations (Airbnb, n.d.-a). This gives businesses in the creative industry, like Massovka, a chance to promote their offerings to a global audience seeking out authentic, local experiences.

From a marketing perspective, Airbnb serves not only as a booking system, but also as a promotional platform that builds awareness and trust in local businesses (Avantio, 2025). By listing on Airbnb, local enterprises can position themselves within a global peer-to-peer ecosystem, where services are offered directly by individuals or small businesses to consumers, without intermediaries (Souza et al., 2019).

This allows Massovka to reach new audiences and promote its workshops in a more authentic and personal way. Therefore, it is important to take a closer look at what the category Airbnb Experience entails and the requirements for listing an experience.

1.6.1 Rules and requirements for listing events on Airbnb

A workshop listed as an experience must meet Airbnb's quality standards and requirements. According to information from the platform's official website, the experience must adhere to three key principles (Airbnb, 2021):

1. **Expertise.** The workshop organizers should share their experience, provide a brief background story and use this unique opportunity to engage platform users.
2. **Insider Access.** It is recommended to offer workshop visitors an unusual and fascinating activity that sets the experience apart from competitors.
3. **Connection.** Experience providers strive to connect with participants and create an inclusive environment where guests from different countries feel comfortable, safe and actively involved in the workshop or event.

All these elements are recommended to be included in the workshop description so that the guest knows the organizer, the event plan and any additional services if applicable (Airbnb, 2021).

The next mandatory requirement is the ID verification of the organizer. The process is straightforward and does not require significant effort or time. Requirements for Airbnb Experience include (Airbnb, n.d.-b):

- identity verification (government-issued ID, email, phone number).
- payment verification (valid payout methods and billing details).
- verification of licenses and certifications, if applicable (for workshops involving cooking, alcohol, sports, wellness or health-related activities).

In the case of Massovka's workshops, license or certification verification is not required, as complex technical tasks, such as firing a clay piece in a kiln, are carried out by the master independently, without the client's participation (Maiska, A., personal conversation, March 2, 2025).

Another requirement for listing an event on the platform is business eligibility. Businesses can list their experiences on Airbnb if they offer a personalized, hands-on activity led by a dedicated individual from the company. If other people are involved, they can be added as co-hosts or assistants (Airbnb, n.d.-b).

The last requirement a host should consider before listing the experience is a service charge of 20% of the cost of the workshop itself. This amount is automatically deducted once the guest completes the booking (Airbnb, n.d.-c).

Given the outlined requirements, there are no obstacles to Massovka listing its workshops on Airbnb platform.

1.6.2 Audience of Airbnb platform

This paragraph examines the platform's audience from a market segmentation perspective, providing a comprehensive profile of Airbnb customers.

The Airbnb platform has two distinct audience segments: hosts and guests. Property owners rent out their spaces either to generate income from unused space or to connect with people from different parts of the world, offering them an opportunity to experience the culture of the destination country. Hosts in the Airbnb Experience category provide tourists with leisure or travel-related services, such as guided tours, historical site visits, culinary or art

workshops and much more. There are two types of visitors on the Airbnb platform: those who rent lodging and those who make experience reservations (Start.io, 2022).

Airbnb carefully analyses the demographic, psychographic, behavioural and geographic characteristics of its clients in order to effectively interact with its target audience. This helps the platform to tailor better its marketing strategies and communication.

Demographic segmentation

From a demographic perspective, Airbnb's audience is slightly skewed toward women with approximately 54% of users being female and 46% male (Start.io, 2022). Families account for about 20% of all reservations made through Airbnb, while solo travelers make up 25% of total bookings (IPROPERTYMANAGEMENT, 2025).

For accommodation services, the primary demographic group ranges from 18 to 45 years old. However, the audience for Airbnb Experiences is broader, spanning 18 to 60 years old, as older generations often show interest in events or workshop listings. This age distribution is closely linked to the employment status of guests. Accommodation and experience attract students, full-time employees and professionals, while experiences, in particular, also appeal to senior managers and high-level executives (Start.io, 2022).

Behavioural segmentation

According to Dudovskiy (2019), behavioural segmentation of Airbnb's target audience is based on several key consumer behaviour characteristics. Customers of Airbnb are categorized into three groups based on their degree of loyalty: the most devoted users who often select Airbnb, those who occasionally choose it over other options and users who regularly move between different rental services.

Customers are also segmented based on the benefits they seek. Some prioritize cost savings and variety, while others are drawn to unique and different experiences. The personality characteristics of Airbnb's audience often include sociability, determination and ambition. Additionally, Airbnb considers users' engagement status, classifying them as non-users, potential users, first-time users and regular users (Dudovskiy, 2019).

Psychographic segmentation

Airbnb uses psychographic segmentation, targeting different social classes and their lifestyles. The platform attracts individuals from the working, middle and upper classes, offering accommodation and entertainment options that align with their needs and expectations. Additionally, Airbnb considers lifestyle diversity, appealing both to the mainstream audience, which seeks comfort and reliability, and to specific consumer types such as "aspirers", who strive to improve their social status; "explorers", who seek unique experiences; and "reformers", who value innovation and authenticity (Dudovskiy, 2019).

Geographic segmentation

Geographic segmentation of Airbnb operates on a global scale, covering over 191 countries and regions and approximately 100,000 cities worldwide in the accommodation segment. This allows the company to meet the demand for lodging in both urban and rural areas. In the experiences segment, Airbnb offers over 30,000 different activities across the world, primarily concentrated in cities. This approach enables Airbnb to cater to a diverse international audience interested in both unique urban experiences and rural adventures (Dudovskiy, 2019).

According to Statista (2025), the highest number of booked nights and experiences in 2024 was recorded in the EMEA region (Europe, the Middle East and Africa), reaching 201 million bookings, followed by North America with 154 million. The lowest number of bookings was observed in the Asia-Pacific region, with 61 million. These figures highlight the dominance of EMEA and North America as Airbnb's key markets (Figure 5).

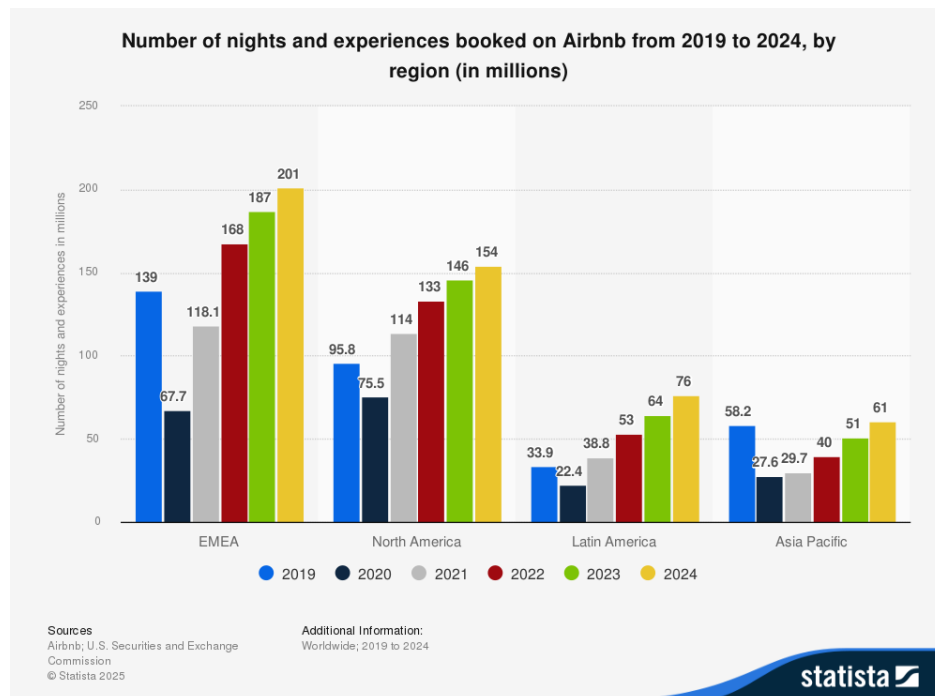


Figure 5. Number of nights and experiences booked on Airbnb from 2019 to 2024, by region (in millions) (source: Statista, 2025a)

The bachelor thesis examines the audience more interested in the experience segment, as this data is necessary for comparison with Massovka's target audience. The audience that aligns with the new marketing strategy will be identified based on a comparative analysis.

1.6.3 Overview of Airbnb's competitors

This paragraph examines Airbnb's competitors, which compete globally and offer activities and events that attract tourists. The following online platforms are presented in descending order according to their global market share, based on data from Statista.com (Statista, 2025b). These companies represent key players in the travel and experience industry and

will be later compared to Airbnb Experience using a perceptual mapping tool in the analytical part of this thesis.

1. Booking.com

Founded in 1996 by Dutch startup founders, Booking.com has become a global leader in the travel industry. It provides access to transportation, leisure activities and accommodation, including private homes and hotels of all types. The platform is available in 43 languages and features over 28 million listings, allowing users to find suitable options for their travels. Even though Booking.com has just started selling experiences, their primary focus is still a place to stay. Experiences are usually listed in a more monotonous manner, with less attention to host involvement and uniqueness (Booking.com, n.d.).

2. Expedia

Founded in 1996 as well, Expedia is an online travel platform that operates similarly to a traditional travel agency. Travelers can use it to look for and reserve hotels, rental cars, flights and vacation packages in one place. In addition, the platform offers travelers access to leisure activities, referred to as “things to do”. These experiences, however, are often organised and managed by third-party operators, limiting the ability to offer the host-driven and emotionally engaging events typical of Airbnb Experience (Expedia Group, n.d.).

3. Tripadvisor

Tripadvisor is one of the world’s largest travel platforms, with 463 million monthly users searching for accommodation, restaurants, activities, cruises and flights. It allows users to plan and budget their trips by comparing prices with various services. Tripadvisor is available in 28 languages across 49 countries and owns 12 tourism-related subsidiaries. Even though Tripadvisor’s listings contain some unique events, these are typically organized by outside vendors and do not have the casual, immersive ambiance that Airbnb’s business model fosters (TripAdvisor, n.d.).

4. Viator

A subsidiary of Tripadvisor, Viator specializes solely in organizing private and group excursions worldwide (Viator, n.d.). The portal provides a wide range of activities, ranging from simple sightseeing tours to extreme adventures, with almost 400,000 experiences available (Needham, 2025). The platform offers a selection of free and paid attractions, as well as free cancellation of tours and activities at least 24 hours before they begin. It is less suited to impromptu, customized workshops, as the majority of listings are still built on strictly planned group tours (Viator, n.d.).

5. GetYourGuide

GetYourGuide is a growing online marketplace that advertises unusual tours and excursions. The project was launched in 2009, and their website features over 140,000 activities in 10,000 cities worldwide. All experiences are carefully selected and locally

verified. Traveler reviews and recommendations are also thoroughly checked by the platform's team. While the company positions itself as a provider of unforgettable local experiences, the platform's structure still leans towards supervised tourism rather than host-led creative immersion (GetYourGuide, n.d.).

In contrast to the platforms above, Airbnb Experiences emphasizes small, host-led activities that create an emotional and often personal connection between the visitor and the event. Its focus on local authenticity and informal storytelling makes it particularly attractive for creative businesses like Massovka that aim to offer hands-on, beginner-friendly experiences. A more detailed comparison of these platforms, including their positioning relative to Airbnb Experiences, is presented in Chapter 2.1.6: Perceptual map, competitive positioning of Airbnb Experience.

1.6.4 Indirect competitors and alternative leisure choices

It is crucial to recognize that Massovka also faces indirect competition from a variety of recreational options in addition to direct competitors offering creative workshops or experiences on travel platforms. These include places such as cafes, restaurants, wine bars, galleries, cinemas that can act as substitutes for creative workshops, especially for those looking for a relaxing or engaging activity (Hollensen, 2016).

Another relevant factor is the way users discover such activities. For options, people might look through Instagram or TikTok, use websites like Airbnb or Google "things to do in Prague" (Buhalis & Law, 2008). In this context, Massovka faces competition not only from other experience providers but also from internet attention-grabbing content and general entertainment possibilities.

While these alternatives do not offer the same type of service, they fulfill similar emotional or social needs and influence the customer's final decision. Acknowledging their role is essential in understanding the full scope of the competitive environment.

1.7 Conclusion of the theoretical part

The theoretical part of this bachelor thesis is dedicated to a literature review, defining general terms and concepts, and searching for secondary information. It examines the transition from traditional to digital marketing. The main section explores the structure of marketing strategy development and key marketing tools such as STP, SWOT analysis, the IE matrix and STDC models, which are essential for creating an effective marketing strategy. The chapter concludes with a description of experience marketing and its application in the creative industry. Additionally, secondary data on Airbnb's target audience, segmented by demographic, psychographic, geographic and behavioural characteristics are also presented, along with an overview of the platform's requirements for hosting events and its competitors. The theoretical knowledge and data on segmentation and marketing approaches obtained in this chapter will be applied in the practical part of this bachelor's thesis to analyse and develop a marketing strategy for Massovka.

2 Practical part

This chapter presents the practical development of a marketing strategy for Massovka's integration into Airbnb Experiences. It begins with an analytical background based on internal and external evaluations, audience alignment and competitive positioning. These findings serve as a foundation for the qualitative research and step-by-step strategy outlined in later sections.

2.1 Analytical background

The primary objective of this part of the thesis is to gather and evaluate the information required to develop a marketing strategy for Massovka on the Airbnb platform. This section analyzes the internal and external environment of the art studio, including the target audience, strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats. The alignment between the target audiences of Airbnb and Massovka is also examined to assess the potential for their strategic integration. The final part of the section is devoted to comparing Airbnb with other platforms offering travel experiences in order to justify the choice of Airbnb as an effective promotional channel.

2.1.1 Interview with the owner of Massovka

In order to gather comprehensive information on the company's target market, strengths, weaknesses, market opportunities and threats, the owner of Massovka was interviewed. An overview of the company's current marketing and operational activities was also gained during the in-depth conversation. The interview aimed to:

- identify the characteristics and preferences of the target audience
- assess customer satisfaction level
- determine the key advantages and weaknesses of the company
- explore potential directions for business expansion
- analyze the marketing channels used and evaluate their effectiveness.

The interview was conducted with Anna Maiska, the CEO and co-owner of Massovka, who has been managing the creative studio for over two years. Anna directly manages the creative aspects and strategic planning of the business, while the second CEO supervises the operational management and development of the business. The interview took place in person at the Massovka art studio on March 2, 2025, in a question-and-answer format. The interview lasted about one hour. The questions and answers are presented in the Appendix section of the thesis, labeled as Appendix A. The answers are unchanged and directly translated from Russian to English.

The data obtained during the interview serves as the basis for creating the target audience profile, conducting a SWOT analysis and assessing the company's strategic position using the IFE and EFE matrices.

2.1.2 Massovka company overview

The following overview of Massovka is based on an in-depth interview with Anna Maiska, the studio's CEO and co-owner.

Massovka, as a creative studio based in Prague, offers various artistic workshops such as pottery, painting and additional events led by invited instructors. The company allows participants to create a finished piece in a single session, which sets it apart from other artistic studios that require multiple visits. Massovka is equipped with specialised tools, including two kilns for firing clay products and a professional potter's wheel.

The team consists of ten people, including instructors and marketers responsible for promoting all the workshops on social media. The studio hosts both group and individual classes, with freestyle modeling and pottery wheel classes being the most popular. More than half of the customers return for additional visits, and a structured loyalty program helps retain them.

Despite identifying as a seasonal business, the company maintains its financial stability and keeps expanding. Strong teamwork is the foundation of Massovka's internal operations, and employees are chosen for their abilities to enhance the environment and their desire to become a member of the Massovka family rather than their past ceramics expertise.

In the near future, the company plans to move to a more spacious location in the center of Prague to expand its storage capacity for equipment and materials, attract customers with higher income and increase its visibility.

As a brand, Massovka is known for its accessible and informal approach to creativity. The studio has a friendly and relaxed atmosphere. It helps new clients feel comfortable trying out a creative activity for the first time. Customers often choose Massovka for the flexibility it offers in completing projects, the ability to redo a piece at no extra charge and the welcoming environment of the studio.

Although the brand does not position itself as a place for socializing, it provides a shared experience that many find enjoyable and memorable. Marketing efforts primarily rely on Instagram target advertising and word-of-mouth recommendations. Despite occasional misunderstandings related to clients' expectations or pricing, customer satisfaction remains high. The brand's reputation in the ceramic community is very high, and it is recognized by its colleagues, many of whom use Massovka's kilns for their own work.

Massovka aims to expand its reach and enhance its branding to appeal to a more premium market segment. The company remains open to new ideas and promotional channels.

The following sub-paragraphs provide a more detailed description of the company's target audience, competitors, strengths and weaknesses, based on a conversation with the co-owner Anna Maiska.

2.1.3 Target audience of Massovka

Based on the data obtained through an in-depth interview, the target audience of Massovka was segmented according to demographic, behavioural and psychographic characteristics.

Demographic segmentation

The majority of the audience is women between 20 and 35 years of age. Most visitors speak Russian, although the studio also serves a segment of English and Czech speaking clients. These are primarily locals and expats, foreigners who temporarily or permanently residing in the country for personal or professional reasons. Reflecting the wide age range, the studio is oriented to children from 12 years and above, adults and seniors (in certain cases, up to 60 years and older). However, younger children are not a priority audience because they are uncomfortable in adult oriented environments and have little ability for long concentration.

Behavioural segmentation

Customer behaviour is characterized by a high level of engagement. More than 50% of participants return, indicating a loyal audience and a stable client base. Approximately half of the visitors come to the studio alone, while the other half attend with a friend or partner. Men, in particular, tend to visit workshops less frequently on their own. More often, they accompany their female partners. Customer motivation varies: some clients attend with a specific goal in mind, such as creating a particular kitchen item (for example, a set of dishes). Others see the workshops as an opportunity to spend time in a pleasant atmosphere and gain experience in making something unique.

Psychographic segmentation

The target audience is tending to creative self-expression and seeks to create “meaningful things”, showing a strong interest in the aesthetics of handmade work. Many value not just the final result but also the process itself and the feeling of creative relaxation. Unlike traditional craft studios that emphasize professionalism and strict technique, Massovka offers a friendly, informal environment that supports freedom and ease. The lack of strict rules and skill requirements makes the studio attractive to beginners of all genders, including those with no previous experience in ceramics.

Additional insights from the in-depth conversation with the co-founder reveal the audience's preferences regarding workshop formats. Group workshops are the most popular format among participants. The second most preferred option is private classes, which offer more personalized experience. Thematic and exclusive events have less demand. The pottery wheel workshop is often associated with romantic movie scenes, and it is

particularly popular among couples. In contrast, female clients more frequently choose modeling sessions without a specific theme, appreciating the opportunity to improvise.

In terms of price sensitivity, Massovka's clients often note the relatively high cost of workshops. In such cases, the owners explain the specifics of the production process, including the high cost of equipment, the time required for kiln firing and energy consumption. This usually leads to greater understanding, and most clients accept the established pricing. At the same time, the current loyalty program with discounts for repeat visits encourages customers to visit the studio again. It helps to reduce the negative perception of the pricing policy. To summarize, Massovka's audience is a loyal and engaged group of customers focused on creativity, self-expression and having a unique experience in a comfortable and friendly atmosphere.

To summarize, Massovka's audience is a loyal and engaged group of customers focused on creativity, self-expression and having a unique experience in a comfortable and friendly atmosphere.

2.1.4 Overview of Massovka's Workshops

This sub paragraph provides a general overview of all workshops that customers can participate in at Massovka art studio. The information about the classes was taken from their official website Massovkapraha.cz and Instagram page. The interview with co-owner Maiska Anna supports the workshops' description in Table 5.

Type of workshop	Description	Suitability for Airbnb Experience
Ceramic workshops (General group workshop: tea set, plate making, glazing, clay and wine, painting ready-made ceramics, botanical imprint, candle making, movie night with clay modeling, free topic; Individual workshops: potter's wheel, couples' sessions)	Ceramic workshops are the most diverse and popular category in Massovka. Participants work with clay using hand-building techniques or the potter's wheel and can choose from thematic sessions or creative free topics.	Not suitable. Although creative and unique, these workshops are limited by a long production process. Finished products are only ready after three or four weeks due to drying and kiln firing. While delivery is possible, it is financially impractical for both the studio and international guests.
Painting workshops (art evening and affirmation)	These workshops focus on creativity and mindfulness. Participants create abstract or themed artworks on canvas and may combine the process with writing positive affirmations.	<i>Suitable</i> . No special tools or prior knowledge are required. The artworks can be taken home immediately, which makes it ideal for short-term visitors.
Sweets creating workshops (marshmallow, Dubai chocolate)	During these sessions, participants learn to make sweets such as	<i>Suitable</i> . These workshops are interactive, time-efficient and allow

	marshmallows or chocolate using quality ingredients and personalized recipes.	participants to enjoy the sweets in the studio or take them home, which aligns with the Airbnb Experience model.
Mosaic workshop (mosaic mirrors)	A hands-on decorative workshop where participants create mosaic designs, most commonly on mirrors. The process involves arranging and gluing tile fragments.	<i>Suitable</i> . Offers a unique creative activity with a tangible result that can be taken home the same day or week. It is beginner-friendly and visually attractive for promotion online.

Table 2. Overview of all Massovka's workshops (Massovkapraha.cz, 2025; own processing)

Based on the evaluation above, all workshops marked as *suitable* meet the key criteria of Airbnb Experiences: they are friendly for beginners, time efficient and provide an emotionally valuable outcome that visitors can take home the same way. Therefore, the marketing strategy created in the practical part of this thesis can be effectively implemented for the sweets format of workshops. It offers an immediate result that guests can even enjoy at the studio with coffee or tea, which makes it a great first choice for testing the platform.

2.1.5 Comparison of Massovka and Airbnb Experience audiences

To evaluate whether it makes sense for Massovka to use Airbnb as a platform for promotion, a comparative analysis of the target audiences of both platforms was conducted. The results are shown in the table below (Table 2). Information about Massovka's audience was gathered through primary research, an in-depth interview with the company's co-founder. The Airbnb audience profile is based on secondary data from industry sources and marketing research. The goal of this comparison is to assess how closely the key characteristics of the two target groups align and to explore the potential for integrating Massovka into the travel experiences segment.

Category	Massovka art studio	Airbnb Experience services
<i>Age</i>	Mainly 20–35, with a range from 12 to 60+	Primarily 18–60
<i>Gender</i>	Mostly women	Women — 54%, men — 46%
<i>Language</i>	Russian-speaking, English-speaking and Czech participants	International audience, main language — English
<i>Geography</i>	Residents or temporary visitors in Prague	Tourists from all over the world, especially Europe, North America and the Middle East

<i>Social status</i>	Young professionals, creative class, expats	Students, employees, freelancers, mid- and senior-level managers, family travelers
<i>Preferred visit format</i>	50% come alone, 50% in pairs; men more often come in pairs	Solo travelers, couples, groups, families
<i>Motivation</i>	Aesthetic experience, creative expression, creating something meaningful	Searching for a unique, local and authentic way to spend their free time
<i>Experience level</i>	Most participants do not have formal art education	No special skills required, emphasis on accessibility
<i>Activity format</i>	Group workshops, private sessions, completing a finished piece in a two hour visit	Individual or group activities, tours, workshops — short and rich in content
<i>Repeat participation</i>	Over 50% of clients return	Usually one-time participation (during the trip), but high interest and engagement
<i>Event atmosphere</i>	Informality, coziness and a friendly atmosphere are highly valued	Preference for a warm, welcoming environment and the chance to connect with locals
<i>Psychographics</i>	Interested in art, harmony, aesthetics and self-expression	“Explorers” looking for novelty, uniqueness, local flavor and authenticity
<i>Behavioural traits</i>	Attend based on recommendations, take part in promotions, value personal experiences	Spontaneous bookings, responsive to ads and creative formats
<i>Competitive advantage</i>	Completing a piece in one session, ability to recreate the item later, unique atmosphere	Local, authentic, accessible and interactive experiences
<i>Attraction channels</i>	Instagram, Facebook ads, word-of-mouth, own website (in the future plans), loyalty programs	Airbnb’s internal algorithm, search queries, recommendations
<i>Price perception</i>	Some clients are price sensitive but willing to pay when the process and effort are explained	Willing to invest in a unique experience, especially among middle- and upper-class travelers

Table 3. Comparative table of key audience characteristics of Massovka and Airbnb Experience (2025, own processing)

The comparative analysis shows a high degree of alignment between Massovka's target audience and Airbnb Experiences users. This indicates the potential for Massovka to successfully enter the Airbnb experience ecosystem by adapting its format to meet the expectations of the tourist audience.

Even though Massovka's main audience falls in the age group from 20 to 35, the art studio is open to expanding the age category to 60 and above, which corresponds with the profile of Airbnb Experience customers. In both cases, women are the more active participants and often influence the decisions of their male partners when choosing events. Language is not a barrier, as English is the expected language of communication in Massovka's workshops.

The behavioural characteristics of the audience also match. Participants do not necessarily have professional skills in art but are eager for self-expression and creativity in a relaxed, welcoming space. The short, informal and results oriented format of Massovka's workshops fully meets the expectations of travelers looking for intense and time efficient experiences.

Psychographically, both groups seek personalized leisure activities. They value authenticity, aesthetics and the opportunity to engage with local culture. Airbnb Experiences users are often described as "explorers" who are open to new experiences, which resonates with Massovka's audience.

The main difference is the length of stay: Massovka focuses on Prague residents, while Airbnb targets tourists visiting the city temporarily. However, due to the flexibility of the workshop format, as well as the possibility to adjust schedules and session lengths, the art studio is able to offer the product to short term guests as well.

In conclusion, Massovka has all the necessary conditions to enter the Airbnb Experience platform and promote itself among travelers. This forms the strategic foundation for the marketing campaign presented in the following chapter.

2.1.6 Situational analysis

The next section focusses on the company's present market position and identifies variables that may affect its success.

SWOT analysis of Massovka company

The next stage of this bachelor thesis involves evaluating the internal and external factors influencing the development of the Massovka art studio. For this purpose, a SWOT analysis was conducted (Chapter 1.4.5). The information was primarily obtained through an in-depth interview with the company's co-owner (Appendix A) and supported by customer feedback gathered during qualitative research (Appendix B). Below are the key strengths and weaknesses of the company, as well as the opportunities and threats in the external environment.

Strengths:

- **flexible and client oriented workshop format.** The studio offers the possibility to create a finished product in a single session lasting around two hours, which is convenient for clients. If a piece gets damaged, customers are offered a free redo.
- **pleasant and accessible atmosphere.** Massovka is welcoming to both experienced artists and complete beginners. The lack of entry requirements lowers the barrier to participation and contributes to customer loyalty.
- **high level of customer loyalty.** According to internal data, more than half of all visitors return. The studio runs a loyalty program with discounts and small gifts.
- **strong reputation.** Massovka is well known in the Prague ceramics community. Based on the founder's estimate, around 95% of people interested in pottery in Prague have visited the studio at least once.
- **qualified and motivated team.** The staff include marketing, SMM, and content specialists, as well as multilingual instructors, which makes it easier to communicate with international clients.
- **unique and high-end equipment.** The studio is equipped with two professional kilns and premium pottery wheels, setting it apart from competitors.
- **effective customer acquisition.** Most of the traffic is generated through targeted ads and word-of-mouth, allowing the studio to maintain a steady flow of new and permanent clients.

Weaknesses:

- **seasonal demand fluctuations.** Interest in classes tends to decrease during the summer due to vacations and high temperatures.
- **limitations of the current location.** Massovka moves to a more suitable location almost every year when space cannot keep up with growing demand.
- **financial risks during low seasons.** In periods of lower revenue, the owners may need to contribute personal funds.
- **price sensitivity of customers.** Clients sometimes need extra explanation of the pricing structure before accepting the service cost as reasonable.
- **dependence on clay quality.** Different clay batches vary in properties, and limited storage space prevents bulk purchases.
- **low efficiency of influencer marketing.** Promotion through bloggers has not yielded the expected results so far and needs a revised approach.

Opportunities:

- **relocation to the city center.** A new central location would offer better visibility and accessibility for the target audience.
- **development of new workshop formats.** There is potential to introduce workshops that don't require long waiting times for results, such as painting, decorative crafts, or chocolate and jelly-making classes.
- **partnerships with local businesses.** Collaborations with cafes, restaurants, and galleries can expand audience reach and strengthen local integration.
- **use of travel platforms.** Listing activities on specialised websites will provide access to the tourist market.

- **development of the website and online booking.** The newly launched website has high potential for generating organic traffic and increasing bookings.
- **targeting higher-income audiences.** Relocation and price adjustments can help position Massovka as a premium creative space.
- **opening a cafe at the studio.** This would boost the studio's appeal and attract more casual visitors.

Threats:

- **rising electricity costs.** Operating pottery kilns involves significant electricity expenses, making the business vulnerable to tariff changes.
- **difficulty in finding suitable premises.** The studio needs a space with modern wiring, ample room, natural lighting and a separate entrance, which narrows down the options.
- **mistakes in handing over finished pieces.** Occasionally, customers accidentally take someone else's item, which requires compensation or problem solving.
- **limited storage capacity.** The current studio setup does not allow for storing large volumes of materials, affecting the consistency of the production process.
- **dependence on digital channels.** Customer acquisition heavily relies on platforms with constantly changing algorithms (Instagram, Facebook), which creates risks if their policies shift.
- **limited reach of the traditional market.** Without expansion onto external platforms, the studio risks hitting a saturation point within Prague.

The SWOT analysis revealed the key internal and external factors influencing the growth of Massovka art studio. The studio's strengths, such as its flexible workshop format, strong customer loyalty and skilled team, allow it to successfully manage external challenges like seasonal demand and rising operational costs. At the same time, unexploited opportunities, including developing new workshop formats and expanding to travel platforms, highlight potential growth directions.

To better assess the company's strategic position and justify the choice of specific development paths, it is appropriate to apply quantitative analysis methods. The following sections present the EFE (External Factor Evaluation) and IFE (Internal Factor Evaluation) matrices (Chapter 1.4.2), which help measure the company's adaptation to its external environment and the efficiency of using internal resources. These results will form the basis for evaluating Massovka's strategic position in the IE matrix and for developing corresponding marketing strategy.

Internal factor evaluation

The IFE matrix helps quantify the relative importance and impact of Massovka's internal strengths and weaknesses, identified through the SWOT analysis. It provides a structured overview of the studio's internal environment (Table 3) and contributes to determining Massovka's strategic position later in the IE matrix (Figure 6).

Key internal factor	Weight	Rating	Weighted Score
Strengths			
Flexible workshop format	0.10	4	0.40
Cozy atmosphere, friendly for beginners	0.08	4	0.32
High level of customer loyalty	0.10	4	0.40
Strong reputation in the professional community	0.08	4	0.32
Qualified and motivated team	0.07	4	0.28
Availability of professional equipment	0.07	3	0.21
Effective client acquisition	0.10	3	0.30
Weaknesses			
Seasonal fluctuations in demand	0.10	2	0.20
Limitations of the current location	0.08	2	0.16
Financial risks during the low season	0.07	2	0.14
Price sensitivity among clients	0.05	2	0.10
Dependence on raw material quality	0.05	2	0.10
Low efficiency of influencer marketing	0.05	1	0.05
TOTAL	1		2.98

Table 4. Internal Factor Evaluation (IFE) matrix (2025, own processing)

Each factor was assigned a weight according to its importance for successful performance within the industry. The total of all weights equals 1.0. Then, each factor was given a rating on a scale from 1 to 4, reflecting the level of importance in Massovka's current operations:

- 4 - major strength: a well-developed factor that gives the company a significant competitive edge;
- 3 - minor strength: a positive aspect with capability for improvement;
- 2 - minor weakness: a challenge that is manageable and not critical;
- 1 - major weakness: a serious limitation requiring immediate attention.

Strong points received higher ratings of 3 or 4, while weak points were rated 1 or 2. After multiplying weights by ratings, the total weighted score amounted to 2.98. This result is above the average benchmark of 2.5, indicating that the company has a strong internal position.

Massovka demonstrates an ability to effectively leverage its key internal resources, especially its team, workshop format and loyal customer base, to maintain stability and drive growth. At the same time, it manages to navigate existing internal challenges such as seasonal demand fluctuations and space limitations. This strong internal foundation supports the company's potential for expansion and strategic adaptation.

External factor evaluation

The EFE matrix provides a structured approach to evaluating how well Massovka responds to external opportunities and threats identified in the SWOT analysis. It measures the studio's strategic adaptability to its environment (Table 4) and is later used to determine its position on the IE matrix (Figure 6).

Key external factor	Weight	Rating	Weighted Score
Opportunities			
Relocation to the city center	0.13	4	0.52
Working with new workshop formats	0.10	2	0.20
Developing partnerships with local businesses	0.08	2	0.16
Using travel platforms	0.09	2	0.18
Website and online booking development	0.10	3	0.30
Reaching higher-income audiences	0.09	3	0.27
Opening a cafe at the studio	0.07	2	0.14
Threats			
Rising electricity costs	0.11	3	0.33
Difficulty finding suitable premises	0.08	3	0.24
Mistakes in delivering finished pieces	0.05	4	0.20
Limited storage capacity	0.04	3	0.12
Dependence on external digital platforms	0.04	2	0.08
TOTAL	1		2.74

Table 5. External Factor Evaluation (EFE) matrix (2025, own processing)

In the EFE matrix, each external factor was assigned a weight from 0.0 to 1.0 based on its relevance in the current market conditions, and a rating from 1 to 4, where 1 means a weak response and 4 reflects an excellent response from Massovka. The final total score 2.74 is

above the benchmark of 2.5 that indicates a relatively high level of adaptability to external conditions.

Massovka has been most successful in leveraging opportunities such as relocating to the city center, which has led to increased client traffic and stronger brand positioning, and the development of online booking, which continues to expand its reach to new audiences. At the same time, some areas remain underdeveloped. New workshop formats and partnerships with local businesses are still in the early stages, and the use of external platforms for promotion has not yet been implemented.

These results highlight the importance of focusing more actively on external growth opportunities and confirm the validity of the next stage of analysis, determining Massovka's strategic position within the IE matrix.

Internal-External matrix

Based on the IFE score of 2.98 and EFE score of 2.74, Massovka is positioned in cell V of the IE matrix, which corresponds to the “hold and maintain” strategy (Figure 6).

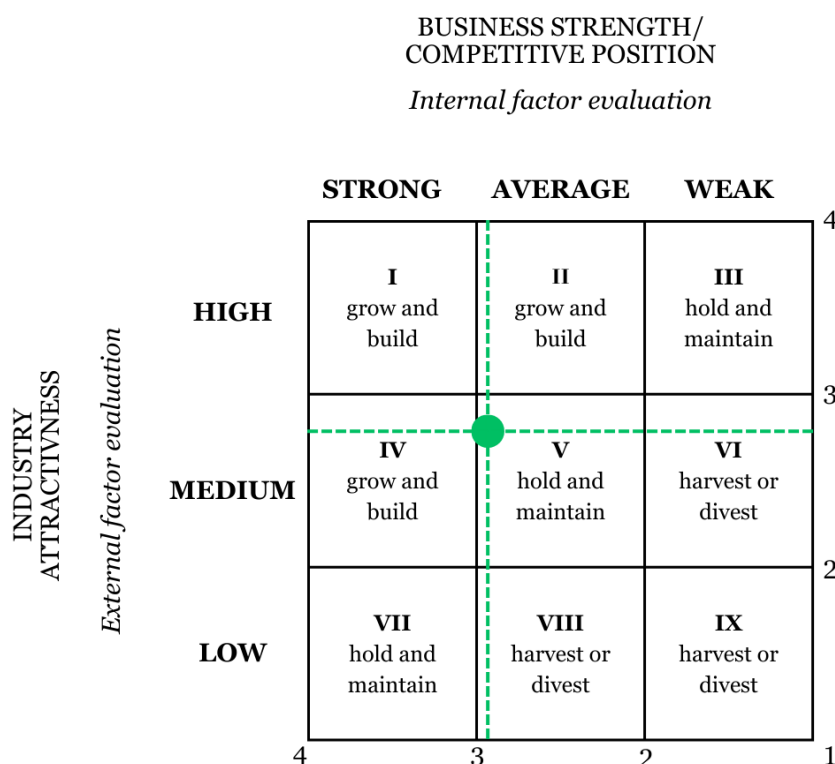


Figure 6. Internal-External (IE) matrix strategic positioning of Massovka (own processing)

This suggests that while the company is performing well, especially internally, it should focus on strengthening its core operations and maximizing the effectiveness of existing resources. Instead of aggressive expansion, Massovka should refine its service offering, improve operational efficiency and gradually explore new marketing channels, such as Airbnb.

Perceptual map, competitive positioning of Airbnb Experience

This section focuses on analyzing the competitive positioning of the Airbnb Experiences platform in comparison to other online services offering travel related activities. The comparison is based on secondary sources and an analysis of official websites. The results are visualized in a perceptual map (Figure 7).

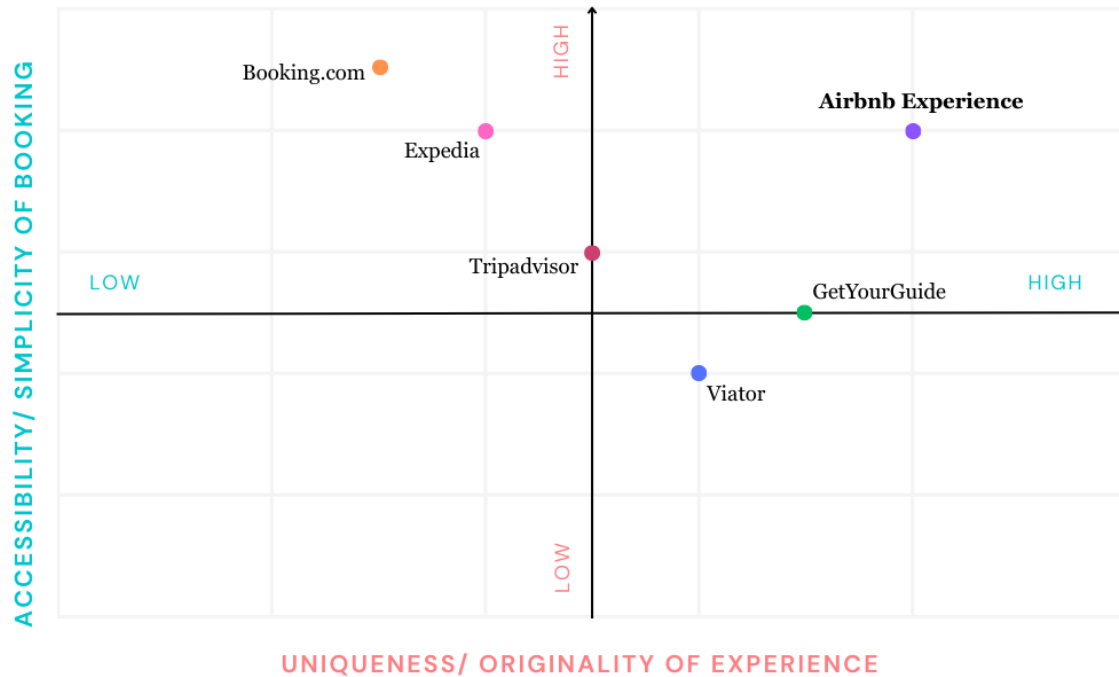


Figure 7. Perceptual map: Airbnb Experience and competitors (2025, own processing)

The perceptual map is built on two key dimensions relevant to consumer decision-making: uniqueness and originality of the experience (X-axis), and accessibility and ease of booking (Y-axis).

These two dimensions were chosen because they reflect the core positioning criteria that distinguish Airbnb Experiences from its competitors, as identified in the theoretical part (Chapter 1.6.3). Uniqueness captures the emotional and creative value of the offering, while accessibility reflects the digital convenience and booking functionality central to user expectations.

This structure reflects current preferences of travelers, who seek local, authentic experiences with smooth and convenient digital access (Buhalis & Amaranggana, 2015). Research shows that platforms offering a balanced combination of these attributes tend to generate stronger emotional engagement and higher customer satisfaction (Pine & Gilmore, 1999).

Airbnb Experience scores highly on both dimensions. It enables users to discover and book authentic, locally hosted events that go beyond traditional tours. These include creative workshops, wellness retreats and other unique or specialised experiences that are hard to

find on traditional travel websites. At the same time, Airbnb's user interface, integrated payment system and mobile accessibility make the user experience and convenience better (Tussyadiah & Pesonen, 2016).

In comparison, Booking.com and Expedia are primarily focused on accommodation and traditional services. Their experience offerings lack the unique and community-based elements that Airbnb promotes on its platform.

Tripadvisor operates as a hybrid platform combining reviews and bookings. It offers a moderate degree of accessibility and originality, but it mainly depends on outside companies that give regular tours to destinations that are already on the list. While Viator, a Tripadvisor subsidiary, offers a lot of possibilities, its perceived distinctiveness is diminished because it primarily concentrates on regular group outings and organized tours.

Though it still functions more like a platform that gathers and sells tours than one that focuses on immersive and personalized travel experiences, GetYourGuide tries to offer unique and locally verified activities.

As illustrated in the perceptual map, Airbnb Experiences stands out in the top-right quadrant, representing both high originality and high accessibility. This strong positioning sets it apart from competitors that either lack personalization or offer a less user-friendly booking opportunity. By offering a balance of unique, locally hosted activities and a convenient digital interface, Airbnb aligns closely with the modern traveler's preference for immersive and easily accessible experiences.

Therefore, the choice of Airbnb Experiences as Massovka's promotional channel is strategically reasonable. Its alignment with travelers' demand for unique, engaging and local experiences makes Airbnb an ideal environment for promoting creative activities. This will help the studio increase brand awareness while meeting the expectations of modern travelers who value individualized leisure formats.

Conclusion of the analysis

The analytical background of this bachelor thesis focused on evaluating Massovka's internal resources and external environment to assess the feasibility of promoting its creative workshops through Airbnb Experiences. The analysis confirmed a strong strategic fit between the studio's positioning, customer profile and the expectations of Airbnb users.

The SWOT analysis identified key internal strengths such as high customer loyalty, flexible workshop formats and a welcoming atmosphere, as well as opportunities related to platform promotion and audience expansion. The IFE and EFE matrices showed that Massovka effectively manages its internal operations and is relatively well adapted to external conditions. Based on these results, the IE matrix placed the company in a "hold and maintain" position, suggesting a cautious and resource-efficient approach to trying new communication channels.

The comparison of Massovka's audience with Airbnb Experience revealed a high degree of alignment in values, behaviours and motivations, especially among experience seeking

tourists. In addition, the perceptual map positioned Airbnb as a leading platform in terms of originality and accessibility, making it a strategically relevant channel for promoting Massovka's beginner-friendly workshops.

Building on these findings, the next section presents qualitative research designed to further explore customer behaviour and emotional drivers for creating the final strategy.

2.2 Qualitative research

2.2.1 Research objective and methodology

The practical part of the thesis includes qualitative research in the form of interviews aimed at gaining a deeper understanding of the behaviours and preferences of current and potential Massovka's customers. This research (Appendix B) was conducted to better understand the motivations, expectations and emotional barriers of the target audience when booking creative workshops and to identify the communication formats that resonate with them most effectively. The main insights serve as the foundation for creating a communication strategy tailored for Airbnb platform.

The qualitative method was chosen as the most appropriate approach, as the goal was not to measure customer behaviour statistically, but to explore personal attitudes, subjective experiences and emotional factors influencing their behaviour. Since the strategy developed in this thesis focuses on emotional connection and experience perception, qualitative research provides more relevant input for strategic decision making.

In total, nine interviews were conducted with individuals representing three different segments of the target audience. All respondents fit the general target profile of Massovka company and Airbnb Experience service:

- **Group A:** current customers of Massovka who have attended a workshop
- **Group B:** users of the Airbnb platform who frequently book experiences while traveling
- **Group C:** residents of Prague who fit the target demographic profile but have not previously visited Massovka

Each interview lasted approximately 15 minutes. Respondents followed a prepared set of open-ended questions but allowed for natural conversation flow, including subsequent questions and clarifications when needed. The primary aim was to identify:

- Motivations behind booking creative workshops
- Barriers to booking
- Preferred communication channels and platforms
- Expectations from Airbnb hosted experiences
- Tone, language and visuals that attract or discourage participation

The transcripts of these conversations are presented in Appendix B. The following sections provide a detailed analysis of the target groups and key insight derived from this research.

2.2.2 Target group profiles and audience segmentation

All the interviews were carefully structured to include participants from three distinct audience segments. The audience groups were selected based on both Massovka's current customer profile and the potential user base of the Airbnb Experience platform, as defined in the analytical and theoretical parts of the thesis. Each group represents a specific level of awareness and engagement with creative workshops and travel platforms, providing differentiated perspectives relevant for strategic segmentation and communication design.

Group A: Current Massovka customers (3 interviews)

This segment includes individuals who have previously attended Massovka workshops at least once. Their responses provided important reflections on why customers choose the studio, what they value in the experience and what factors influence their loyalty and word-of-mouth behaviour.

The participants in this group were aged between 22 and 34 and included local expats and Czech citizens. Despite varying reasons for attending, from a personal creative outlet to spending quality time with a partner, all interviewees described the experience in emotional terms, emphasizing atmosphere, informality and relaxation. Their motivations were driven not by artistic skill, but by the need to disconnect from routine, try something new and enjoy a peaceful environment.

All participants in this segment were familiar with digital booking tools, but none of them had discovered Massovka through Airbnb, which confirms that locals still associate Airbnb mainly with accommodation or tourist activities. However, all of them expressed that they would consider using Airbnb for workshops if they were travel visitors or if it offered more visibility.

Group B: Airbnb Experiences users (3 interviews)

This group included individuals aged 19 to 58 who regularly use Airbnb to book local activities when traveling. Their responses were essential for identifying the communication tone, visual style and booking behaviour typical for Airbnb guests, especially those open to arts and culture experiences.

Interviewees from this segment showed a strong interest in experiences that feel authentic and hands-on. They were attracted to storytelling, host personality and the promise of "something different". These users tend to make decisions based on Airbnb visuals, short and friendly descriptions and reviews.

They were not looking for technical, expert guided classes but for a memorable activity that adds emotional or sensory depth to their trip. Short duration (up to 2 hours), no

requirement for prior experience and the ability to take home something handmade were seen as clear advantages.

This group confirmed that Airbnb is a trusted discovery tool, especially for tourists looking for last minute or weekend plans. The emotional vocabulary used by participants (“cozy”, “chill”, “safe”, “personal” and “authentic”) sets a clear benchmark for Airbnb focused communication.

Group C: Local Potential Customers (3 interviews)

This segment involved Prague residents who were unfamiliar with Massovka but fit its target demographic, creative individuals between 19 and 39 years old with interest in culture, design or self-development.

These participants expressed curiosity about creative workshops but also hesitation. Barriers included: not knowing where to find reliable workshops, feeling unsure whether the experience is “for them” and sensitivity to pricing. They tended to discover new activities via Instagram, Google search or personal recommendations, and associated Airbnb mainly with accommodation or tourism.

It can be noted that all participants agreed that if a creative workshop was presented in a simple, friendly and beginner oriented form, they would be more likely to attend. They valued communication that shows real people, natural spaces and emotional benefits. While price was a concern for some, the perceived value increased significantly when the experience offered emotional output, personal items to take home and a welcoming environment of art studio.

Summary of Segmentation Findings

These three groups align closely with the segmentation framework described in the theoretical part of the thesis (Chapter 1.4.4), particularly in terms of behavioural and psychographic segmentation. Common features across all groups include:

- A preference for informal and emotionally rewarding experiences
- Interest in self-expression and creativity over technical skill
- Attraction to inclusive, relaxed messaging and visuals
- A desire to feel safe and welcome, especially for first-time participants

These shared characteristics across all three groups underline the importance of addressing emotional drivers and psychological barriers in the communication strategy. The following section summarizes these findings into main communication insight for developing a marketing strategy on Airbnb platform.

2.2.3 Key findings and insight formulation

The interview results revealed repeating emotional and behavioural patterns across all three target groups. Although participants differed in age, nationality and previous experience with creative workshops, they consistently highlighted similar values and concerns. These

findings offer a strong foundation for shaping the communication strategy for Massovka's listing on Airbnb Experiences.

➤ **Booking creative workshops is an emotional decision**

Participants did not view workshops as skill building opportunities but rather as a chance to disconnect, relax, and engage in something meaningful. The main motives mentioned across all interviews included:

- Relaxation and mindfulness (Interviewees 1, 3 and 5)
- Sharing and creating memories together (Interviewees 2 and 6)
- Creative escape and self-expression (Interviewees 4, 7 and 9)

The workshop was perceived not as a class, but as a safe space to disconnect from routines, try something new and take home something personally meaningful. Interviewees emphasized the atmosphere and tone of the experience more than the technical outcome.

➤ **Fear of “not being good enough” is a major barrier**

Fear of failure or not being creative enough was the most obvious emotional barrier in the interviews. Some interviewees said they were hesitant to try a workshop because they were afraid of making mistakes, did not know if the activity was for beginners or just did not feel they were the creative type of person.

This barrier is especially strong for those who are the new participants or unfamiliar with ceramics. It is not a lack of interest that prevents booking, self-doubt and uncertainty.

➤ **Visuals and language greatly influence trust and appeal**

Participants across all segments described what visual elements attract their attention. They consistently preferred:

- Behind the scenes process shots (such as hands shaping clay, studio moments)
- Warm, cozy lighting and authentic, real people (not overly styled photos)
- Relaxed and personal wording such as “no skills needed” or “just come as you are”

Language that sounded too artistic, professional or abstract was seen as discouraging, especially among locals and new visitors who feared being judged or excluded.

➤ **Airbnb is trusted by tourists, but underused by locals**

For tourists, Airbnb was seen as a reliable discovery platform, especially for spontaneous, short term experiences. However, locals did not associate Airbnb with finding cultural or hobby based events, even those who are interested in creative workshops.

This insight supports a strategic focus on tourists as the primary audience for Massovka's Airbnb-based promotion. While locals remain an important long-term segment, they may be better reached through alternative channels more aligned with their discovery behaviour.

➤ **Simple and clarifying message of the workshop**

Participants across all groups responded positively to short, simple messaging that communicated warmth, informality and emotional impact. This aligns with the STDC model's early stages (See and Think), where curiosity and emotional connection are more important than detailed structured information.

Communication insight

A clear marketing communication insight was formulated according to the OUA model (Chapter 1.4.5), and it based on the gathered key findings from the interviews and target audience analysis:

Travelers choose creative workshops over sightseeing tours because they offer a more memorable, personal and emotionally engaging experience. At the same time, many hesitate to book because they fear not being creative enough, or they are unsure about the difficulty level and outcome. That is why Massovka shows them that it is not about skills but about slowing down, getting your hands messy and leaving with something that feels like you.

Airbnb's Experience feature is the ideal channel to deliver this message. It attracts experience-driven travelers and allows Massovka to communicate authenticity, warmth and accessibility directly where they are looking for something unique.

While this insight primarily reflects the motivations of experience seeking travelers, interviews also revealed that local participants may have slightly different expectations. They tend to view workshops more as a social or leisure activity and are more likely to consider practical aspects such as price, scheduling and friends recommendations when making a booking decision (Appendix B. Group C: Locals who do not know Massovka yet).

This insight will serve as the foundation for the development of Massovka's communication strategy in the following sections. It addresses the emotional barrier directly and repositions the workshop not as a test of skill, but as a relaxing and inclusive experience.

2.3 Defining goals for marketing strategy

The communication insight developed in the previous section serves as a foundation for shaping the marketing strategy that will help integrate Massovka into Airbnb Experiences platform. To ensure a focused and effective strategy, it is necessary to define clear objectives that align with the research question and respond to the behavioural and emotional patterns identified during the interviews.

Primary goal

To ensure that within the first 12 months of listing on Airbnb Experiences, at least 10 % of all new customer bookings for the sweets workshops are made directly through the Airbnb platform,

based on the total number of bookings tracked via Airbnb's host dashboard compared to total bookings for sweets workshops across all channels.

This goal was created based on the SMART method mentioned in the theoretical part (Chapter 1.4.3). It was discussed with and approved by the co-owner of Massovka during the evaluation phase of the proposed strategy (Chapter 2.5). The goal offers a measurable and realistic benchmark for evaluating the initial success of Massovka's entry into the Airbnb Experiences platform. The choice to focus on sweets workshops is based on their suitability for short-term visitors and instant value, as outlined in the analytical part of the thesis (Chapter 2.1.4). By setting the target at 10 % of total bookings for sweets workshops, the strategy aims to achieve a meaningful yet attainable share of customer acquisition through Airbnb, without overestimating the platform's early stage impact.

This percentage reflects a balanced approach: it is ambitious enough to indicate clear platform potential and conservative enough to account for the fact that Airbnb is a new communication and sales channel for the studio. Given that Massovka has previously relied on local networks and social media for customer acquisition, reaching 10 % through a single external platform represents a strong signal of successful diversification. Furthermore, this goal aligns with the company's current "hold and maintain" strategic position (Chapter 2.1.6), where careful allocation of resources and controlled testing of new channels are prioritized. If the campaign outperforms this metric, it will support Airbnb's expansion into other types of workshops in the future.

Secondary goals

To support the achievement of the primary goal, several secondary objectives have been established. These are based on the most frequently mentioned emotional and practical barriers identified in the interview research (Appendix B), the motivational triggers discussed in Chapter 2.2.3 and the best practice guidelines for listing optimization provided by Airbnb's Experience host resources (Chapter 1.6.1). Together, they aim to address customer hesitation and enhance the perceived value of the workshop experience.

- 1) Show the accessibility of the workshops by eliminating the fear of lacking certain skills.

The listing must clearly communicate that the workshop is beginner-friendly and does not require prior artistic experience. Simple and encouraging language should be used to normalize imperfection and encourage participation.

- 2) Visually represent the atmosphere and authenticity of the art studio.

Airbnb users make decisions quickly and are highly responsive to visuals. Based on interview insights from both travelers and locals, Massovka should use visuals that evoke warmth, inclusivity and an informal creative atmosphere. Behind the scenes photos, process imagery and informal expressions are prioritized over overly styled or polished content.

- 3) Establish trust and emotional appeal through the host's personality.

The Airbnb Experience format favors human connection, so listing must include a personal story or message from the workshop host.

- 4) Ensure clarity and transparency in workshop expectations, duration and outcome.

Several respondents expressed uncertainty about what the workshop includes and whether it is “worth the price”. To confront this, the listing should provide a clear description of the process, duration, expected outcomes and what is included in the price.

These objectives together ensure that the developed marketing strategy will not only effectively promote Massovka within the Airbnb ecosystem, but also meet the psychological, emotional and informational needs of its potential customers. Each goal will be presented as an actionable step in the next chapter of this thesis, which outlines the structure of the marketing strategy in detail.

2.4 Marketing strategy

This chapter presents a step-by-step marketing strategy for promoting Massovka's creative workshops through the Airbnb Experiences platform. The strategy is structured using the STDC model (Chapter 1.4.5). It focuses on removing psychological barriers and strengthening emotional motivation to ensure a consistent and welcoming communication tone across all interaction points. The strategic approach is directly based on findings, gathered through qualitative research, platform analysis, communication insight and goals set in the practical part of this thesis.

See phase

Audience: Tourists browsing Airbnb Experience and looking at the listed experiences in Prague. They do not have a fixed plan for their vacation but would like to do something unique.

Content: This phase begins when the user has entered the necessary search parameters (destination, period of stay, number of guests) and applied filters according to their preferences. An attractive bright photo showing people engaged in the activity is the first thing that the user pays attention to. By looking at this image, they can get an idea of what the workshop is about and partially imagine its atmosphere. A clear and simple title is the next element that captures the user's interest. An example of how this phase appears is shown in Figure 8. The map with workshop locations helps the user orient themselves in the location of the event and determine whether it is convenient for them. They proceed to the next phase by clicking on the workshop's name or photo.

This is also the phase where the communication insight developed in Chapter 2.2.3 becomes especially important to use. Since many users are uncertain whether such creative workshops are meant for them, the initial visual and textual elements must immediately

reassure them that the experience is welcoming, beginner friendly and emotionally fulfilling. It is not about something that requires artistic skill or confidence.

Channels: The platform user navigates through the following channels: Airbnb Experience feed, search results, “Art and culture” filtered category.

It is important to note that chocolate workshops can be categorized by “Art and culture” and “Food and drink”. Guests design their own chocolate, just like they would paint or sculpt, and at the same time they make something they can taste.

Metrics that help measure how effectively the photo and title of the workshop attract the audience’s interest: number of page views, number of wishlist saves, click-through rate (CTR) from the Experience feed.

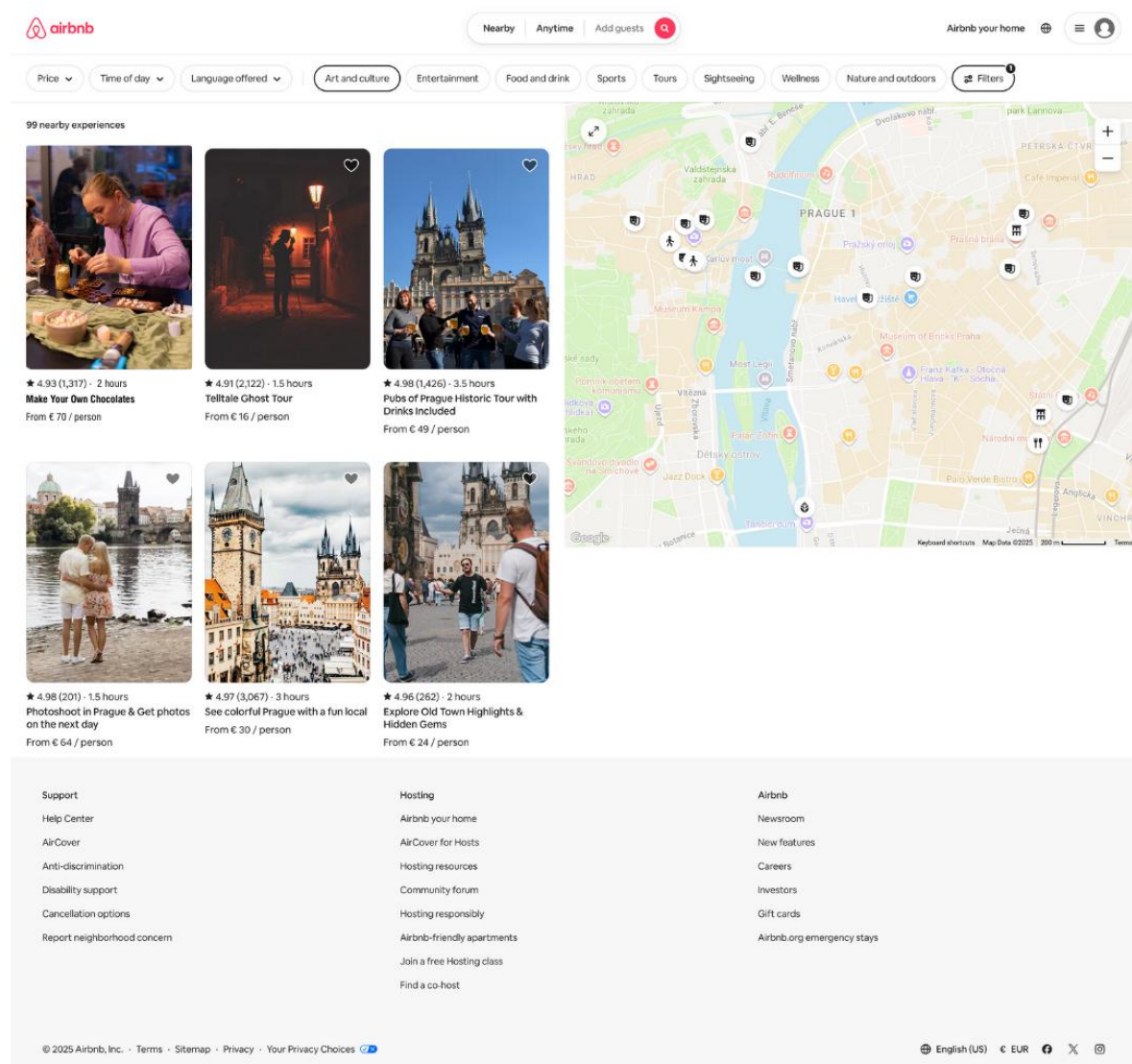


Figure 8. Prototype of the stage See for Massovka’s new strategy (source: Airbnb.com official website, own processing)

The price of 70 euros was calculated by adding a 20% Airbnb service fee to the current price of the chocolate workshop at Massovka studio (1,400 CZK).

Think phase

This is the stage where the communication insight introduced in Chapter 2.2.3 is fully developed.

Audience: Potential customers who have clicked on the Airbnb listing and are now evaluating whether the experience is a good fit for them. They may be curious but hesitant due to self-doubt or lack of experience.

Content: After clicking on the workshop, the potential customer sees its detailed description. Their interest in the event begins to grow. Key elements at this stage include photos of guests who have already attended the event and a brief description of the workshop written in an informal, friendly tone. The description is built to address the customer's needs and trigger points, building trust and creating a desire to experience the event and feel the associated emotions. Additional elements that influence the customer's decision include a small note on the listing from the event host and reviews from past participants (Figure 10). The host's description does not carry a heavy informative load. It is short and friendly, characterizing him as a person willing to share his experience (Figure 9). In order to keep the client in no doubt about the price, it is important to clearly convey the value of the event: what they will gain and what emotions they will experience. If the customer still has questions or wants to get to know the host better, they can use the "Contact host" feature.

Channels: Airbnb listing page (important sections "What you'll do", "Meet your host", "What's included", reviews), Airbnb host messaging feature.

Metrics that measure the effectiveness of the customer journey across all mentioned channels at this stage: number of page views, number of messages sent via chat, wishlist saves.

Nearby
Any week
Add guests
Search icon
Airbnb your home
Menu icon
User icon

[Prague, Czech Republic > Art and culture](#)

Make Your Own Chocolates

★ 4.99 (648)
Prague, Czech Republic
Share
Save

show all photos

Experience hosted by Anna

2 hours • Hosted in English

★ **Once-in-a-lifetime**
Guests say it's special and unique.

★ **Top-rated Host**
Giuliana's rated 5 stars by 99% of guests.

What you'll do

Ready to slow down and make something sweet?

During this cozy 2 hour experience, you'll step into our sunlit art studio in the heart of Prague and learn how to make handcrafted chocolate using natural ingredients and your own creative flair, no experience needed! We want you to enjoy the process!

We'll start by melting high-quality Belgian chocolate and playing with different flavors and textures. You'll choose your own toppings (such as sea salt, dried berries, nuts or gold dust) and pour your mixture into shapes, creating totally custom chocolate bars or truffles.

While they cool, we'll chat over tea, and you'll decorate your gift box to take home (or snack on your creation right away — we won't judge!).

You do not need to bring anything, just yourself! This workshop is great for both individuals and groups, adults and children.

Sooo... at the end, you'll walk away with:

- a personalized box of handmade chocolates (a cool idea for a souvenir!)
- sweet memories
- and hopefully... chocolaty fingers

If you would like to visit us in a different time slot, let us know. We will check availability and add the slot for you:)

What's included

Drinks
tea, capuccino, coffe

Equipment
Necessary tools and materials

Experience hosted by Anna Maiska

Host on Airbnb since 2022

★ 200 Reviews
Identity verified

I live in Prague and love working with my hands. I spend my days surrounded by colors, textures and people from all over the world. I'm someone who finds calm in slow things, like making something from scratch or sharing tea with a stranger.

Friends would say I'm warm and a little quirky (I do rearrange furniture just for fun). I'm not here to teach perfection! just to make sure you feel safe, welcome and proud of whatever you create.

Contact host

 To protect your payment, never transfer money or communicate outside of the Airbnb website or app. [Learn more](#)

From € 70 / person

[Show all prices](#)

DATES	GUESTS	
May 19 - 24	1 guest	
Tue, May 20 2:00 PM–4:30 PM Join 1 other guest		
	€ 70 / person	Choose
Wed, May 21 2:00 PM–4:30 PM Book for a private group		
	€ 70 / person	Choose
Thu, May 22 2:00 PM–4:30 PM Book for a private group		
	€ 70 / person	Choose
Book		

[Report this experience](#)

Figure 9. Prototype of the stage Think for Massovka's new strategy (source: Airbnb.com official website, own processing)

★ 5.0 (200 reviews)



Tatjana

April 2025

I was absolutely thrilled with the workshop and would definitely come again. Everything went great. The ceramic artist explained everything beautifully and patiently. Lovely atmosphere, nice space. Super happy with the whole experience and the creative process. Such amazing relaxation. The staff took great care of us. Thank you for that.



Alina

March 2025

It was amazing! I learned how to make beautiful plates that now decorate my table. The instructors were great and super patient.

[Show more >](#)



Alexandra

March 2025

And I really enjoyed being there! I was having such a bad day, so it truly cheered me up.



Tereza

March 2025

My first try at making plates was unexpectedly successful! It was great fun, and I'm definitely coming back for more ceramic adventures.

[Show more >](#)

Show all 200 reviews

Figure 10. Prototype of the stage Think for Massovka's new strategy, reviews section (source: Airbnb.com official website, own processing)

The customers' feedback posted on the prototype was taken from Massovka's official website as an example of what it should look like. These testimonials are not related to the chocolate workshop for which the strategy was created (Figure 10).

Do phase

Audience: Customers with a strong interest in a creative experience during their stay. They have already decided to book the workshop through Airbnb. They are making the reservation or waiting for confirmation from the host.

Content: At this stage, the customer decides to book the workshop right now and the main aim is to make this process as easy as possible for them. The client only needs to click the 'Book' button and select a suitable time to complete the booking. If the client wants to attend the event but cannot find a convenient time among the available options, they can contact the host directly via a pop-up banner. After the workshop has been paid for, it is recommended to send a personalized booking confirmation to the guest. It makes him feel welcome and build trust in the event. This approach helps the guest realize that the host is looking forward to their visit and that they are not just a number, but a valued customer.

Channels: Airbnb Experience listing's reservation selection section, Airbnb host messaging feature.

Metrics that help measure the success of the phase Do: booking rate, number of last minute bookings, number of bookings following a conversation with the host.

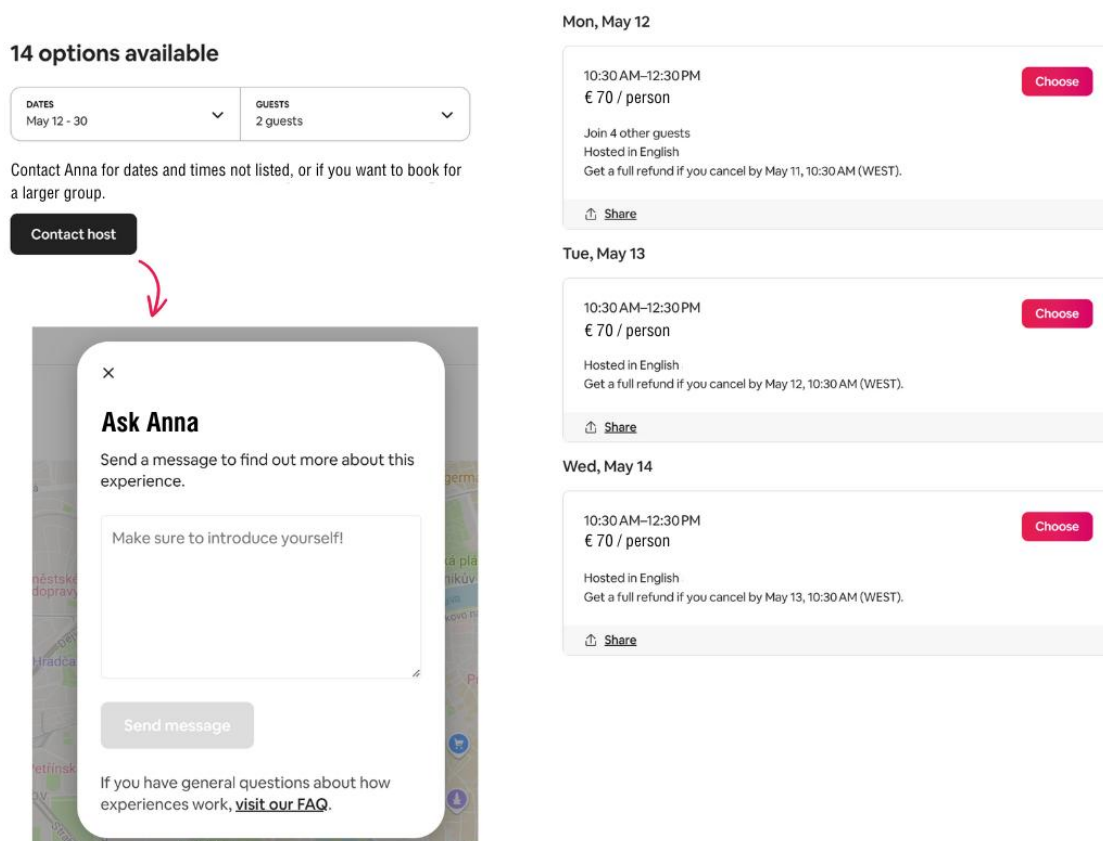


Figure 11. Prototype of the stage Do for Massovka's new strategy (source: Airbnb.com official website, own processing)

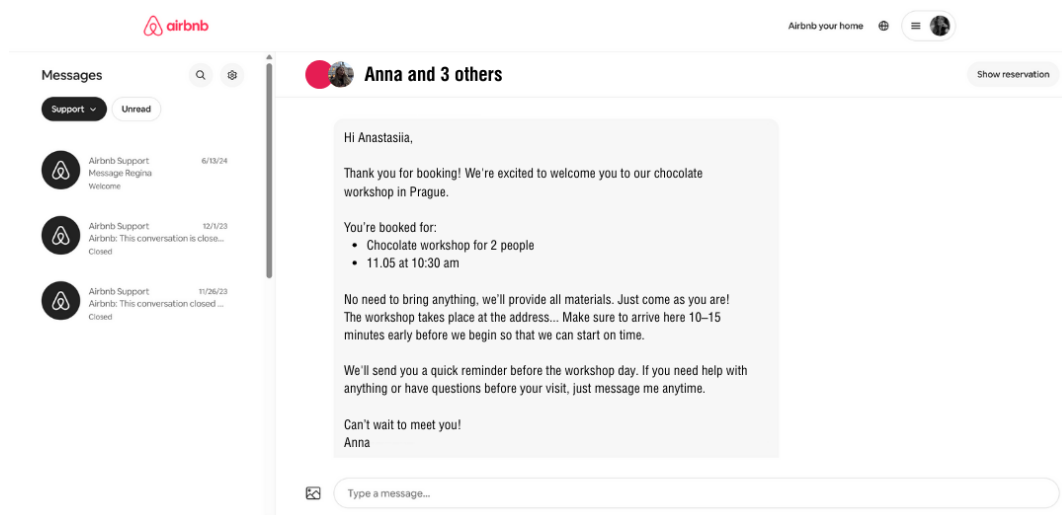


Figure 12. Prototype of the stage Do for Massovka's new strategy, booking confirmation message (source: Airbnb.com official website, own processing)

Care phase

Audience: Guests who have attended the workshop and experienced the atmosphere of Massovka. These individuals are emotionally engaged and may leave a review, recommend the experience to others or consider booking again.

Content: This stage starts from the moment the masterclass is finished in the creative studio. It is important that the client leaves satisfied, with expectations met and a smile on their face. Feeling a sense of belonging to the Massovka community throughout the event and accepting the obtained result as a creative masterpiece are emotionally important for the customer. They remember the experience as something meaningful, personal and worth sharing. At the end of the workshop, the host invites the guests to take a group photo to “capture” the emotions they have experienced (and if it is possible, to tag the studio’s Instagram page). Within one day, it is recommended to follow up with a personalized message, thanking and encouraging them to leave a review about their experience on the Airbnb Experiences platform (Figure 12). This will help further potential customers make a decision in favor of booking this workshop.

Channels: Airbnb host messaging feature, Instagram profile of Massovka

Metrics that measure the success of this phase are the number and quality of reviews left on Airbnb, number of guests who tagged the studio on Instagram.

The metrics mentioned within the entire strategy are automatically visible in the Airbnb dashboard (like bookings, reviews, saves) and can be manually monitored (like tags on Instagram or messages sent).

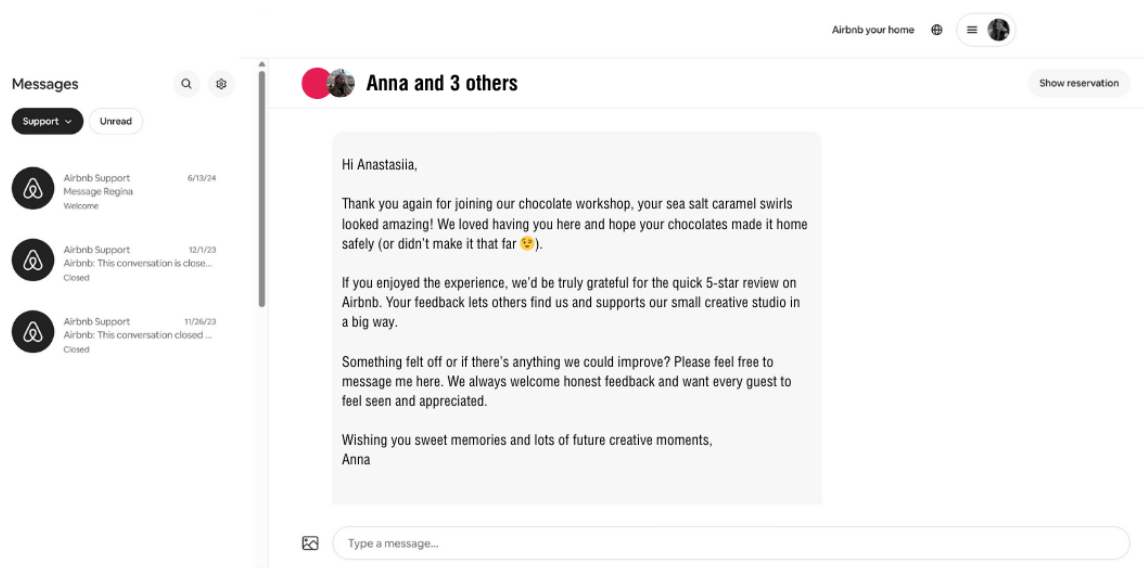


Figure 13. Prototype of the stage Care for Massovka’s new strategy, feedback inquiry (source: Airbnb.com official website, own processing)

To ensure the developed marketing strategy is not only theoretically sound but also practically applicable, it is essential to assess its viability through expert evaluation.

2.5 Evaluation of the strategy

An expert evaluation was conducted to assess the feasibility and clarity of the marketing strategy developed in Chapter 2.4, as the purpose of this bachelor thesis is not to test the

strategy in real life, but to receive professional feedback from the experts with relevant experience in the field. The evaluation was conducted with a marketer Eline S., a startup owner Rehman K. and the co-owner of Massovka company. The evaluation was intended to help determine whether the strategy is understandable and practically applicable based on their knowledge.

Evaluation by a senior marketing consultant

Eline S. is a senior marketing consultant with over six years of experience in digital and brand marketing. She has worked with startups as well as enterprises in Europe, specializing in communication strategy, customer segmentation and experience-driven marketing. Eline was contacted through LinkedIn and after receiving the response from her, the practical part of the thesis (including qualitative research, target audience findings and the strategy description) was sent for review. In order to allow her to assess the concept freely, no structured questionnaire was provided. Instead, she was invited to share her thoughts openly, with particular attention to any unclear sections, weak points or aspects that could be improved before implementation.

In her feedback, the expert praised the overall structure, logic and platform fit of the proposed strategy:

“...I can confidently say that this is a high-quality, well researched and highly feasible strategy. It addresses both business needs and customer psychology, making it very strong from a professional marketing perspective. You based the strategy on real emotional motivators and barriers...”

She emphasized that the approach was clearly grounded in research and that the segmentation of the audience, as well as the emotional insight, reflected a deep understanding of the real motivations behind customer behaviour. According to her, the use of the STDC model was well suited to Airbnb's format. She noted that each phase was clearly defined, with appropriate touchpoints, messaging tone and success metrics. The strategic transition from emotional motivation to action was described as “*very mature for an early career marketing strategy*”, particularly because it avoids overcomplication and focuses on clarity and emotional connection.

However, Eline also provided critical and constructive feedback, which highlighted areas for potential improvement. One of the main suggestions was to develop A/B variants of visual assets already during the early implementation phase. Since Airbnb's algorithm favors higher engagement, testing different photos or titles could significantly increase visibility and click-through rates. She also pointed out that the goal of generating 10 % of sweets workshop bookings through Airbnb is realistic but early traction will heavily depend on the speed of review accumulation. For this reason, she recommended proactively planning how to collect the first five to ten reviews quickly, for example, by offering a small bonus or asking friends or loyal customers to book via Airbnb initially.

Another valuable point raised was the potential for expanding multilingual communication. Although the listing is written in English and targets international travelers, she suggested

that adding a short phrase in other common tourist languages (such as German or French) may further boost trust and inclusivity.

Finally, Eline concluded that the marketing strategy was well suited for a real launch, particularly because it balances strategic thinking with customer empathy and low operational risk. She emphasized that its strength lies in simplicity and precision. It focuses on one workshop format, one channel and one audience segment, which increases the chance of successful testing and future scaling. While some minor improvements were suggested, she confirmed that the core strategy is sound and ready for implementation.

Evaluation by startup owner

The second expert feedback was provided by a startup owner Rehman K., specializing in business growth and digital platform development. This expert received the practical part of the thesis personally and was also asked to evaluate the marketing strategy freely, without being directed by a specific set of questions.

According to this expert, the proposed marketing strategy for Massovka's Airbnb Experience listing was described as "*genuinely impressive*". In particular, the way the STDC model was applied was highlighted as natural and a great suit to the nature of Massovka's creative business. A strong emphasis was placed on the way the strategy addressed real customer emotions, which sensitivity was viewed as a major strength, distinguishing the strategy from many others that fail to address psychological barriers. Additionally, the expert appreciated that the strategy included clear metrics at each phase, making the marketing plan measurable and trackable.

At the same time, the evaluation also raised several critical points for consideration. One concern was that the strategy did not include a scaling plan in case the marketing plan is growing faster than expected. For example, if demand for the chocolate workshops significantly increases, there is currently no contingency plan to maintain the quality of the customer experience. Another point raised was the potential risk of platform dependency. Although Airbnb is an excellent fit at the moment, the expert noted that platform algorithms and user behaviours can change over time and the company should keep themselves updated to those changes.

Despite these critical notes, the overall evaluation was very positive. The expert concluded that the strategy demonstrates a deep understanding of both the platform and the emotional needs of the target audience. If implemented properly and combined with small risk management measures, the marketing strategy could successfully help Massovka establish a new sustainable customer acquisition channel through Airbnb Experiences.

Evaluation by Massovka's co-owner

The evaluation of the strategy by Massovka's co-owner, Anna M., was simple and to the point. She expressed that she was impressed by the way the strategy presented clear, precise texts and customer messages that could be directly implemented without the need for further adjustments. According to Anna, the proposed approach captured the atmosphere

and values of Massovka in a natural and authentic way, which made her confident that the studio's identity would not be lost when entering a new platform.

Importantly, presenting the strategy helped to remove the initial skepticism she had felt about using Airbnb Experiences as a promotional channel. Seeing the strategy broken down step by step, supported by audience research and tailored communication, made her realize that Airbnb could offer a real opportunity to reach a new audience without compromising the studio's friendly and beginner oriented character. Overall, the evaluation confirmed that the proposed strategy resonates not only with marketing experts but also with the Massovka team itself.

Summary of expert evaluation

All three evaluations highlighted the clarity, structure and practical relevance of the proposed strategy. The marketing expert appreciated the way the communication approach addressed emotional barriers and followed the customer journey in a logical and effective manner. The business owner emphasized the strength of the strategy's foundation in research and its potential to attract a new audience without requiring major financial investments. Massovka's co-owner valued the brand consistency and direct applicability of the materials, which helped to overcome her initial skepticism about the platform. Altogether, the evaluations confirmed that the strategy is well-prepared, realistically implementable and aligned with both the studio's values and the expectations of the Airbnb audience.

2.6 Reflection on the research question

The research question of this bachelor thesis was: *How does the integration of Airbnb's platform features influence customer engagement and business growth for Massovka's creative workshops?*

This section reflects on whether this question was answered, based on the results of the theoretical research, qualitative interviews, strategic development, and expert evaluations.

The conducted research showed that, compared to other experience based platforms, Airbnb offers several features that align closely with Massovka's strengths (Chapter 1.6 and 2.2). These include personalized listings, emotional descriptions, user reviews and an algorithm that helps people discover experiences they might not have actively searched for (Chapter 2.2.2). Together, these features support the promotion of short, emotionally meaningful creative workshops like those offered by Massovka. Importantly, the platform does not only function as a booking tool but also acts as a discovery and trust building channel among its users (Chapter 2.2.2). In this sense, Airbnb supports both customer engagement and potential business growth. The engagement can be observed through Airbnb specific metrics, such as profile views, saves and direct contact with the host.

From the audience perspective, the qualitative interviews confirmed a strong match between Massovka's offering and the expectations of Airbnb users (Chapter 2.2.2 and 3.1.3).

These travelers are emotionally motivated, value authenticity and prefer short, beginner friendly formats, all of which are reflected in Massovka's sweets workshops. Emotional barriers such as fear of not being creative enough were identified and directly addressed in the proposed strategy. Based on the qualitative findings and platform analysis, it can be concluded that Airbnb not only attracts relevant customers but also enables overcoming psychological barriers to booking.

The platform's potential to support business growth was assessed through the strategy's SMART goal and expert evaluations (Chapter 2.3 and 3.4). The primary objective of reaching 10% of bookings for sweets workshops through Airbnb was validated by experts as realistic and relevant. All three evaluations confirmed the feasibility of the approach and its potential to expand Massovka's audience without major financial risk. This supports the conclusion that Airbnb can serve as a meaningful addition to Massovka's customer acquisition strategy, especially during its expansion to the city center.

However, according to the expert evaluation, the research also highlighted that platform integration alone does not guarantee engagement (Chapter 2.5). Factors such as visual identity, communication tone and review generation play a key role in performance. In this context, Airbnb's tools are most effective when paired with a thoughtful, insight based marketing approach, as outlined in the STDC strategy developed in this thesis (Chapter 2.4).

In summary, the findings confirm that Airbnb's platform features do positively influence both customer engagement and business development potential for Massovka. The success of such integration depends on how well the experience is positioned, communicated and continuously optimised. The research question was therefore not only answered, but also critically examined through the practical strategy prototype and professional evaluation.

Conclusion

The main goal of this bachelor thesis was to explore how Massovka company can use Airbnb Experiences as a marketing tool for promoting creative workshops. The research mainly aimed to develop a marketing strategy tailored to the platform's audience and features and to evaluate its potential impact on Massovka's customer engagement and business growth. The research question of this thesis was formulated as follows: *How does the integration of Airbnb's platform features influence customer engagement and business growth for Massovka's creative workshops?*

Based on the conducted theoretical research, primary data collection, strategy development and expert evaluations, it can be concluded that integrating Airbnb Experiences offers Massovka a realistic opportunity to reach a new customer segment of tourists and strengthen its position in the creative industry.

The strategy proposed in this thesis focuses on promoting Massovka's sweets workshops through the Airbnb Experiences platform. It is built using the STDC framework, which guides customer communication across four phases: See, Think, Do and Care. Each stage was designed to reflect Airbnb's platform structure and user behaviour, using visuals, tone and messaging aligned with emotionally motivated travelers. The strategy defines measurable goals for bookings and interaction, and selects the sweets format for its immediate, practical experience which is a strong match for short term tourism audiences.

The core communication insight, formulated using the OUA model, highlights that many travelers hesitate to book creative experiences not because of a lack of interest, but because they fear not being creative or skilled enough. Massovka's strategy directly addresses this emotional barrier by reframing the workshop: it is not about artistic results, but about slowing down, getting your hands messy and leaving with something personal. This insight is translated into simple language, informal visuals and a warm, welcoming message, making the workshop feel inclusive and emotionally rewarding from the very first impression.

The platform's features, such as personalized listings, direct guest communication and discovery algorithm, align well with Massovka's strengths, its beginner friendly workshops, emotionally engaging atmosphere and workshops flexibility. The qualitative research confirmed that Massovka's values and experience formats closely match the expectations of Airbnb Experiences users, particularly travelers seeking authentic, short term creative activities.

At the same time, it is important to recognize that Airbnb integration alone will not guarantee success. Initial visibility and customer engagement will depend on gaining positive reviews, maintaining clear and emotionally resonant communication and actively responding to platform updates.

The main findings of the thesis confirm that Airbnb Experiences can serve as an effective tool to support Massovka's business growth, allowing it to diversify its customer acquisition channels beyond traditional local marketing. The developed strategy focuses on promoting sweets workshops, which fit particularly well into the short term, emotionally driven behaviour of the platform's audience.

This research contributes to the broader understanding of how local creative businesses can adapt digital platforms, originally designed for tourism, to promote artistic services. It offers a practical roadmap for small businesses seeking alternative promotion channels without heavy reliance on paid advertising or large marketing budgets.

The main limitation of the research lies in the fact that the proposed strategy was evaluated by experts but not yet tested in real world implementation. Future research could focus on measuring the actual performance of the strategy over time, expanding the offering to other types of workshops and analyzing customer behaviour after the booking is completed.

In conclusion, the integration of Airbnb platform features, if applied carefully and with attention to emotional engagement, can positively influence Massovka's customer engagement and business development, offering a sustainable and innovative path for future growth.

Furthermore, it can be confirmed that the SMART objective defined at the beginning of this thesis was fully achieved. A strategic proposal focused specifically on the integration of Airbnb Experiences into Massovka's marketing activities was successfully developed, evaluated, and aligned with the company's existing resources and operational scale. The results were measured through expert evaluations, which confirmed the feasibility and relevance of the proposed strategy. All planned steps were completed within the thesis timeframe, ensuring that the objective was not only theoretically but also practically fulfilled.

The author of this bachelor thesis fulfilled the main goal of the work and answered on the research question.

Appendix

Appendix A: In-depth conversation with Massovka owner

Question	Answer
Target audience	
Who are your customers?	“Primarily Russian-speaking, with occasional Czech and English speakers. The most common age group is 20 to 35, primarily women.”
What is the minimum and maximum age of your visitors?	“Our workshops are suitable for participants from the age of 12. Children are generally not very interested in adult company and often feel shy around them. Moreover, they may find it challenging to focus for long periods. We have also had clients aged 60 and above, a grandfather who attended a sculpting session with his entire family.”
Do customers typically attend in pairs or alone?	“Attendance is about 50/50 between individuals and pairs. Men rarely attend alone, usually joining with friends or partners.”
How often do customers return for additional workshops?	“Over half our customers return at least twice, making repeat attendance very common.”
What motivates customers to attend your workshops?	“Some people intentionally create their own dishes, for example, they may want a set of identical plates and regularly visit us to make them. Others simply enjoy the experience and atmosphere. While communication is not our primary focus in the workshop, the main goal is for participants to create something meaningful during the session.”
What type of workshops interest them the most?	“The most popular choice among couples is the pottery wheel for two, a shared experience similar to scenes from movies. For women, free-form sculpting is the preferred option. It is an open-ended session where participants can create whatever they like without a set theme.”
Do they prefer group sessions, private lessons or special events?	“Group classes are the most popular, followed by private lessons. Themed and exclusive events have the least demand.”
Are there any workshops where a customer does not have to wait a	“It can be painting pictures, making chocolate or marshmallows. Painting on finished pottery also

long time for the finished product?	requires at least a week of waiting time, as the paint needs to be fired in a kiln.”
Are there any unmet needs that customers express during workshops?	“We haven’t encountered dissatisfied clients. It happens that some people overestimate their abilities, expecting to create something exceptional right away. To prevent disappointment, our instructors inform participants in advance about the level of difficulty and the expected outcome. The main issue arises from unrealistic expectations.”
What is the most common feedback or complaint from your customers?	“Complaints are rare and mostly related to expectations that I said before. Some customers assume that we refine or correct their pieces, which we do not. However, this happens very rarely, perhaps once in 100 cases. Occasionally, defects (in pieces) occur, but we resolve these issues quickly, and overall, clients are satisfied. Throughout the studio’s history, there have been only about four highly dissatisfied customers.”
How price-sensitive are your customers?	“Clients often mention that the prices are high, but lowering them is not possible. For example, a single kiln costs 100,000 CZK. There are no direct complaints, but rather a lack of understanding, as many assume that ceramics should be inexpensive. However, running a studio requires significant investment in equipment, including two kilns, a \$2,000 pottery wheel and high electricity costs. A kiln heats up to 1,400°C, and a single firing takes 18 hours, making the process much more complex than it seems. Clay itself is the least expensive component, but the overall process requires substantial investment. In general, after explaining these costs, clients understand and accept the pricing. Considering the cost of production, our prices remain as affordable as possible.”
How do new customers typically find out about your business? (Word-of-mouth, social media, search engines, ads)	“There are different ways they find out about us. The word-of-mouth and target advertising on Instagram and Facebook are the most popular ones. “
Do you offer loyalty programs or discounts for returning clients?	“Yes, we offer gift certificates and stamp cards, which allow clients to receive discounts and gifts after a certain number of visits. Our loyalty program includes: • 10 % discount on the second visit; • a gift on the fifth visit; • 25 % discount on the eighth visit; • 50 % discount on the eleventh visit.”
What marketing channels have been most effective in attracting	“The most effective tool has been targeted advertising on social media. Our website is new, so

new customers?	it has not yet generated significant results, but it is likely to become an effective acquisition channel in the future.”
Have customers mentioned why they chose Massovka over competitors?	“First of all, they are able to create a piece in one visit.”
What differentiates your business from competitors in the eyes of your customers?	“Unlike many studios that require two visits, one for sculpting and another for glazing, we offer a more flexible approach. Clients can complete their piece in a single session that takes about two hours. Then we can handle the glazing process for them. They simply return later to pick up their finished work. Secondly, we let customers remake the piece. We understand that accidents happen. If a piece cracks, explodes in the kiln or gets damaged, clients can come back and redo it for free, regardless of the cause. As a result, everyone gets a finished work of art, even if their first attempt doesn’t go as planned. Finally, we can proudly say that people choose us for a friendly and comfortable atmosphere. Many studios appear too professional, giving the impression that workshops are only for experienced artisans. This can intimidate beginners who fear their work won’t turn out well. Our atmosphere is completely different, informal and cozy, like visiting a friend’s home. We create a welcoming space where everyone feels comfortable and confident. No prior experience is needed, and no matter what, each participant will create something unique.”
Are there specific customer segments you would like to attract but haven’t reached yet?	“Within our current space, we have likely already reached all potential clients. However, in the future, we would like to focus on a higher-income audience. This transition will take place at our new location, as we are soon relocating to the city center. We aim to elevate our brand, attract a different clientele and significantly increase our prices.”
Questions to identify company’s strengths	
What unique resources or capabilities give your company an advantage?	“One of our main strengths is a unique atmosphere that sets us apart from competitors. While our current location looks great, it is not the most convenient to reach, which is why we are planning a move to a new space in the city centre. Finding a suitable location is also challenging, as we have several key requirements: • a modern building. Older buildings with

	outdated electrical wiring cannot support our kilns. • large panoramic windows. Natural daylight is essential for a comfortable working environment. • direct entry from the street is necessary for accessibility. • a minimum of 100 square meters, as we need enough space for equipment and guests.”
How strong is your brand reputation in the industry?	“In the ceramics community, many people know about us, especially our colleagues. We have a highly popular and well-established social media presence. Among those who have tried pottery in Prague, 95 % have attended our studio at least once. I personally know almost all of our industry colleagues. Some of them even come to us for kiln firing, as not every studio has its own kilns. They are expensive to buy and maintain.”
What are your best-selling workshops or products, and why are they successful?	“Our main offerings are ceramics and painting. In addition, we invite guest experts, such as a pastry chef who conducts master classes on chocolate and marshmallow making. These workshops we add for the variety rather than a main part of our program.”
How would you describe your company’s financial stability?	“Our business is seasonal. Summer is a slower period, as people prefer vacations and outdoor activities over pottery classes. Additionally, working with clay in hot weather is less comfortable. Winter and holidays are peak seasons, with high demand for workshops. Although summer is quieter, overall, we are growing steadily. We also adjust our prices annually to reflect rising costs of materials and equipment.”
How efficient are your internal operations and workflow?	“Our team is our greatest asset. We trained almost all of our instructors with no prior experience in ceramics, except for one. Instead of focusing on their ceramic skills, we prioritized their ability to fit into our company culture and team dynamics. As a result, we have employees who work well together, support each other and contribute to a positive work environment, which positively impacts our business. We overcome challenges daily, but our biggest achievement is that we started this business without a detailed business plan, financial projections or structured strategy. We launched it purely on enthusiasm, and it turned out to be a

	success beyond our expectations. When we started, ceramics were not as popular as it is today. There were very few similar art studios. I personally knew only two small scale workshops. We were the first to open a large studio, and I am proud of that.”
What technologies or innovations give your company an edge?	“Our key advantage is having specialised equipment that not every studio can afford. We think that it is difficult to create entirely new innovations in ceramics, so success depends on how you present your business.”
Questions to identify company’s weaknesses	
What kind of challenges Massovka is facing?	“One of the most common issues is supply chain disruptions and manufacturing defects, which can sometimes be significant. If something goes wrong with the clay during the firing process, it can affect the entire batch of ceramics (for example, material incompatibility or clay cracking). Another challenge is finding suitable studio space. Every year, we outgrow our current location and have to move. Hopefully, our next relocation will be for the long term. Overall, we do not face critical issues, as we resolve all challenges quickly and efficiently. Occasionally, clients mistakenly take someone else’s piece, as some finished items look identical. We do our best to minimize such cases and handle them immediately. If a client refuses to return the wrong item, we offer the affected customer the opportunity to create a new piece or choose another workshop as compensation.”
Are there any skill gaps in your team that need improvement? <i>(for example, lack of language skills, lack of personnel)</i>	“Yes, of course. Ceramics is an art form that takes a lifetime to master. It is impossible to simply learn everything from books. Much of it comes through hands-on experience: understanding material compatibility, firing temperatures and other nuances. These skills develop over years of practice. Our team consists of 10 people: • 2 CEOs (one focuses on the creative aspects, while the other handles operations) • 4 instructors • SMM (social media marketing) manager • Marketing specialist • Targeting specialist • Photographer

	Our instructors speak multiple languages, including Russian, Czech and English. If a client signs up for a workshop and requires a specific language, we assign the appropriate instructor accordingly. “
What financial limitations does the company currently face?	“There are financial challenges, particularly during the low season, when maintaining the studio becomes more expensive. However, when looking at the annual financial cycle, the demand during winter and holiday periods balances things out.”
How well does the company adapt to technological changes and market trends?	“If trends can be adapted to our field, we make an effort to integrate them. However, not all trends are applicable to a traditional craft like ceramics. In terms of design, visual branding and marketing, we actively follow and implement modern trends. This is managed by our specialists. However, the production process itself remains unchanged. We also analyze statistics and marketing performance, tracking how many clients come from targeted advertising and other promotional channels.”
In what areas does Massovka struggle to compete with other businesses?	“At the moment, we do not see any significant areas where we struggle to compete with other businesses.”
What concerns you the most about the business?	“Of course, financial resources are always a concern. It’s important to be prepared for situations where personal investments may be required, as there is no guaranteed high and stable income. That’s why, I think, this business should be driven by passion and dedication, rather than purely financial expectations. We are not concerned about competition or staff shortages.”
Questions to identify market opportunities	
What industry trends are currently favorable for Massovka? Which channel (social media) works best? How many customers come from the website?	“Currently, Instagram and targeted advertising work best for us. The website was launched recently, so it has not started generating traffic yet. We have tried working with influencers, but this approach has not been very effective for us. We noticed that collaborations between local businesses have become a trend in Prague. We are currently testing a joint project with a restaurant. The costs are minimal, and we are awaiting the results. We also attempted to promote our services through Czech bloggers and influencers, but so far

	without success. However, we plan to revisit this strategy in the future.”
Are there any new market segments or customer needs your company can serve?	“At the moment, we believe that Massovka successfully meets the core needs of its customers. Compared to other art studios, our service level is above average. The main issue we currently face is only location.”
Are there potential partnerships or platforms that could strengthen your business?	“It's difficult to give a clear answer at this stage. I recently discovered that it's possible to list workshops on tourist platforms. I was interested in trying it out, but the spots for attractive events were already booked weeks in advance. At the moment, I'm not entirely sure how our business could fit into platforms like these, but I believe it's something worth exploring further.”
How can the company expand into new workshops, markets or locations? Do you think the flow of interested tourists will increase after your move to the city center?	“We have an idea to open a cafe within the studio to attract people from the street, so they can walk in, see that something interesting is happening and hopefully get curious and engaged.”
What are some regulatory changes that could benefit your company?	“External legislative factors have little impact on our operations. The only significant influence comes from electricity prices, as kilns consume a large amount of energy. Currency fluctuations don't affect us much, as we source all materials and equipment within the Czech Republic.”
Is there an increase in demand for your services? (Is there a dependence on the season and holidays?)	“Demand drops during the summer but picks up again afterward. The highest demand is around New Year (from mid-November to mid-January), when nearly all available workshops are fully booked. Czech national holidays do not have a noticeable impact on demand.”
Questions to identify market threats	
Who are your biggest competitors and how do they challenge your business?	“At the moment, we don't have strong competitors. Other studios operate on a different scale and vibe, they are much smaller. In such places there is not enough space and air for creativity, unlike our studio.”
What external factors (economic downturns, inflation, geopolitical events) could negatively impact your business?	“The main external factor that affects us is the cost of electricity, as our equipment requires significant energy consumption.”
Are there any challenges that could stop your workshop? (for example, rent)	“There are no critical threats at the moment, and we have not encountered such situations. Even in terms of potential injuries that could disrupt a workshop, the pottery wheel is completely safe and

	poses no risk of harm.”
How are customer preferences shifting, and how might that affect your business?	“Customer preferences mainly change in terms of design and complexity. At first, people tend to choose simple projects, but when they visit us again, they usually want to try something more advanced or creative.”
Are there supply chain issues or cost increases affecting profitability?	“The challenges are not so much with supply, but with storing clay in the studio. Different shipments can vary in quality, and although we always test the clay, it is impossible to predict with 100% certainty whether it will crack during firing. We cannot store large quantities of clay in our current space, but we are planning to set up a dedicated storage room in the new location.”

Appendix B: Interviews with potential and existing customers

Question	Answer
Group A: Massovka clients who have attended a workshop	
Interviewee 1: 28 years old female Russian expat, designer, solo visitor <i>“I just needed to do something for myself.”</i>	1. How did you find out about Massovka and what made you decide to book this workshop? “I actually saw it on Instagram, one of those sponsored ads. It popped up while I was scrolling at night, and the photos looked really warm and cozy. I liked that it didn’t seem super professional or intimidating.” 2. What was the main thing you were hoping to get from the experience? “Hmm... honestly? Just a bit of peace. I work from home all day, I’m on the computer non-stop. I wanted to just... like, touch something real with my hands. Also, I thought maybe I could make a mug for my boyfriend. But then I kept it for myself, haha.” 3. Have you used Airbnb before, either for stays or for experiences? “Oh, for stays, yes – all the time. Experiences, only once. I did a pasta class in Florence two years ago.” 4. Imagine Massovka was offering the same workshop on Airbnb. Would you consider booking it there instead? Why or why not?

	“Yeah, probably. If I was visiting Prague and just scrolling for something to do, I’d definitely book it. But since I live here, Instagram was faster. I guess it depends on where I’m coming from.” 5. When you look at ads for experiences like this, what kind of visual content catches your attention the most? “Videos, for sure. Especially the ones where they show someone shaping clay with calming music. Like that ASMR vibe. Or seeing the hands working, it’s super satisfying.” 6. What kind of tone or message works best for you in descriptions? “Hmm... something soft and not too salesy. Like “slow down and make something with your hands” or “take a break from your screen” — that kind of stuff. I hate anything that sounds like “discover your inner artist” though, that’s too much.” 7. If you were telling a friend about the experience with Massovka, what would you highlight to convince them to try it too? “I’d say it’s super chill, the people are nice, and even if you think you’re bad at art, you’ll still leave with something that feels like you. And it’s really cozy inside, like you forget you’re in the city for a couple of hours.”
Interviewee 2: 34 years old man from Prague, came with girlfriend for a date <i>"I didn't expect to enjoy it that much, to be honest."</i>	1. How did you find out about Massovka and what made you decide to book this workshop? “My girlfriend found it. She sent me a link on WhatsApp and was like, “We’re doing this on Saturday.” I didn’t really argue, haha.” 2. What was the main thing you were hoping to get from the experience? “Um... to make her happy, mainly. But also just trying something new together. And I figured, even if I mess it up, we’d laugh about it later.” 3. Have you used Airbnb before, either for stays or for experiences? “Stays, yes. I use it for holidays. Experiences — no, I’ve seen the option, but I never really looked into it.” 4. Imagine Massovka was offering the same workshop on Airbnb. Would you consider booking it there instead? Why or why not?

	“If I was a tourist? Maybe, yeah. If I saw photos like the ones on their Instagram and it said “date night pottery,” I think we would’ve gone for it even sooner.” 5. When you look at ads for experiences like this, what kind of visual content catches your attention the most? “For me, it’s pictures of couples having fun. Like laughing, making a mess with clay. That kind of energy is nice. Not just perfectly styled photos.” 6. What kind of tone or message works best for you in descriptions? “Something fun but not cheesy. Maybe like “try something hands-on with someone you like” or “no skills needed, just show up.” 7. If you were telling a friend about the experience with Massovka, what would you highlight to convince them to try it too? “It’s something different to do instead of just going to dinner or watching Netflix. And you get to take home something you made, which is kinda cool. Also, it’s not awkward or too serious.”
Interviewee 3: 22 years old female international student from Germany, came with friends <i>"It just looked fun and aesthetic."</i>	1. How did you find out about Massovka and what made you decide to book this workshop? “My friend saw it on Instagram and sent it in our group chat. The photos looked really pretty: the space, the pottery, even the tools. It had that cozy artsy vibe and we were like “Let’s just do it next weekend.” 2. What was the main thing you were hoping to get from the experience? “Just good memories, honestly. And some time off our laptops. We all have crazy school schedules, so it felt like a fun reset. And I liked the idea of having something handmade to keep.” 3. Have you used Airbnb before, either for stays or for experiences? “Yes, for both. I stayed in an Airbnb in Paris last year and also booked a bike tour through Airbnb when I was in Amsterdam.” 4. Imagine Massovka was offering the same workshop on Airbnb. Would you consider booking it there instead? Why or why not? “Definitely. Especially if I was visiting Prague as a tourist and didn’t know anyone here. Airbnb is like my go-to when I want

	something a bit more unique than just a tour.” 5. When you look at ads for experiences like this, what kind of visual content catches your attention the most? “Bright, soft lighting, people actually doing the activity, not just posing. I also like when the space itself looks cozy and calm. It makes a difference, you know?” 6. What kind of tone or message works best for you in descriptions? “Something light and relaxed. Like “no pressure, just fun” kind of energy. I don’t want it to sound like a course or something serious. Maybe something like “grab a friend and make something with your hands.” 7. If you were telling a friend about the experience with Massovka, what would you highlight to convince them to try it too? “I’d say it’s a chill way to hang out where you actually do something. It’s fun even if you’re not creative, and it’s cool to make a piece you can take home. Plus, the whole atmosphere is very friendly – no pressure, just fun.”
Group B: Airbnb users who use the platform but do not know Massovka	
Interviewee 4: 24 years old male solo traveler from the Netherlands, visiting Prague <i>“I’m always looking for weird little things to do when I travel. Something you can’t Google in two seconds”</i>	1. When you are traveling, do you usually look for local activities like tours, food events or creative workshops? Why or why not? “Yeah, definitely. I usually plan just my accommodation and then freestyle the rest. I try to book one local experience, a food thing or a workshop. Something that feels like I saw a different side of the place.” 2. What platform do you usually use to book experiences? “Airbnb most of the time. I scroll through the “Experiences” tab when I’m bored in the evening. Sometimes GetYourGuide too, but that’s more for like castles or boat rides.” 3. What kind of things make you say “yes” to an experience? “A good host profile. I like to see a face and maybe a little video, makes it feel personal. Also, if the activity feels unique. Like “make a ring with a local artist” or “learn a traditional craft” that gets me. I’m not into big group tours.” 4. Let’s say you see a pottery or art workshop while

	browsing Airbnb. What would convince you to book it? “Photos first: if it looks cozy, not too formal. Also, if it says “no experience needed” because I have none, haha. And if it’s short, 1.5 to 2 hours is perfect.” 5. Have you ever booked something creative like pottery or painting on a trip? If not, would you be open to it? “I did a tile painting class in Lisbon. It was outside, with wine, it was super chill. I’m definitely open to those. I like it when I get to keep something I made too.” 6. What type of visuals or descriptions make a creative experience look more appealing to you? “Behind the scenes shots. Like, clay on the hands, people focused, maybe laughing. That stuff sells it better than just the finished products. And in the text, something casual and friendly, not too serious.” 7. What kind of messaging would not work for you that would make you scroll past? “Anything that sounds like “learn from a master” or talks about technique a lot. I just want to try something fun, not get a diploma.”
Interviewee 5: 58 years old woman, Canadian couple traveling through Europe <i>“We’re not into big tours anymore. We like experiences where we can sit down, slow down and feel a bit more local.”</i>	1. When you are traveling, do you usually look for local activities like tours, food events, or creative workshops? Why or why not? “Yes, absolutely. We’ve started booking more of those now than we did in our 30s. Less sightseeing, more doing. It helps us connect with the place, especially in smaller settings.” 2. What platform do you usually use to book experiences? “Mostly Airbnb. Sometimes through local tourism sites, but Airbnb is just easier and more polished.” 3. What kind of things make you say “yes” to an experience? “Good reviews and a sense of atmosphere. I don’t want it to feel like a class or a performance, more like we’re welcomed into someone’s world. Also, I look at whether it’s close to our accommodation and not too long.” 4. Let’s say you see a pottery or art workshop while browsing Airbnb. What would convince you to book it?

	“Clear explanation of what’s involved, time needed and something like “you’ll leave with your own handmade piece”. That’s lovely. I also appreciate when it’s led by someone who clearly enjoys hosting, not just teaching.” 5. Have you ever booked something creative like pottery or painting on a trip? If not, would you be open to it? “We did a painting and wine evening in Rome, it was a highlight! We’ve been meaning to try ceramics, actually.” 6. What type of visuals or descriptions make a creative experience look more appealing to you? “Natural lighting, warm colors. When I see clutter free, cozy spaces with smiling people, it puts me at ease. And the description should be calm and informative, not too much slang or hype.” 7. What kind of messaging would not work for you that would make you scroll past? “Anything that sounds too hectic. Or too targeted at young party goers. If it says something like “crazy fun” or “party vibes” we’re out.”
Interviewee 6: 19 years old female Erasmus student from France, on a tight budget <i>“I love doing little things like this when I travel, it makes me feel like I live in the city for a moment.”</i>	1. When you are traveling, do you usually look for local activities like tours, food events or creative workshops? Why or why not? “If it’s affordable, yes. I love trying new things, especially creative ones. I like when it’s something I couldn’t just do at home.” 2. What platform do you usually use to book experiences? “Mostly Airbnb, but sometimes I just DM people on Instagram if I see something interesting in the city I’m in.” 3. What kind of things make you say “yes” to an experience? “If it feels unique and personal. I don’t want to be part of a big tour with like 20 people. Also, I usually check the vibe of the host, I want to feel safe and welcome.” 4. Let’s say you see a pottery or art workshop while browsing Airbnb. What would convince you to book it? “If it’s under 30 euros, lasts less than 2 hours and the photos show a cute space. And if it’s beginner-friendly. I get

	intimidated by stuff that looks too pro.” 5. Have you ever booked something creative like pottery or painting on a trip? If not, would you be open to it? “Yes! I painted a tote bag once at a pop-up event in Berlin. It was so fun. I’m totally into that kind of thing.” 6. What type of visuals or descriptions make a creative experience look more appealing to you? “Something friendly and modern. Like pastel colors, people smiling, and nice table setups. And if they write something like “bring your creativity, we’ll take care of the rest”, that works for me.” 7. What kind of messaging would not work for you that would make you scroll past? “If it looks too fancy or exclusive, like it’s for professionals only. Or if it says “luxury” or something, I’d feel like it’s not for me.”
Group C: Locals who do not know Massovka yet	
Interviewee 7: 29 years old woman from Czech Republic, marketing manager <i>“I always say I want to do more creative things, but then life gets in the way.”</i>	1. Do you ever go to workshops or hands-on creative events in Prague? Why or why not? “Honestly? Not really. But I always want to. I follow a couple of pages on Instagram, such as candle making, painting stuff, but I just never get around to actually booking. I guess I need someone to push me.” 2. If you were to look for something creative to do, where would you search first? “Probably Instagram. That’s where I find most local stuff. I don’t really use Facebook anymore and I wouldn’t think of Airbnb unless I was traveling.” 3. What makes you trust or choose one workshop provider over another? “If I can see people enjoying themselves in the photos. Like real people, not staged models. Also reviews, or if a friend went and recommended it. A nice website helps too, but I’m more likely to trust a brand with active stories and highlights on Instagram.” 4. If you saw a creative workshop listed on Airbnb, would you be likely to try it? Or would you prefer to book directly?

	“I think I’d rather book directly if it’s a local place. Airbnb makes me think it’s for tourists. But if I saw something cool on Airbnb and it looked legit, I wouldn’t mind booking there either.” 5. How much would you be willing to spend for a two hours hands-on experience (like painting or pottery)? “Around 800–1000 CZK feels fair. Maybe more if it includes something like drinks or snacks. But I’d definitely expect to take something home.” 6. What kind of vibe or tone works for you in advertising? “Chill, artsy, maybe a bit witty. Not “inspirational quote” energy, but something that feels real. Like “come make a mess and leave with a masterpiece.” 7. Is there anything that would immediately make you say “no thanks” when looking at these kinds of events? “If it looks too serious or formal. Or if it’s full of people posing in fancy clothes. Also anything that feels like I have to perform or be good at it, I’d be too nervous.”
Interviewee 8: 39 years old man, Czech, IT professional, dad of two children <i>“I like the idea of doing something completely different from what I do all day.”</i>	1. Do you ever go to workshops or hands-on creative events in Prague? Why or why not? “Not often. I’ve done some with my kids, like Christmas ornament painting or baking, but nothing for myself. I guess I never thought about it that way.” 2. If you were to look for something creative to do, where would you search first? “Probably Google. Like “pottery class near me” or something. I’m not on Instagram that much, so I wouldn’t see ads there.” 3. What makes you trust or choose one provider over another? “Clear information, good photos and easy booking. If the website is confusing or has no pictures, I just move on.” 4. If you saw a creative workshop listed on Airbnb, would you be likely to try it? Or would you prefer to book directly? “If the price was the same, I wouldn’t care. I’d use Airbnb. But if it felt more expensive or like it was only for tourists, I’d skip it. I like supporting local businesses directly when I can.” 5. How much would you be willing to spend for a two hours hands-on experience (like painting or pottery)?

	“Hmm, 1000–1200 CZK maybe. If it's a gift or a date idea, it feels worth it. For something I'd do alone, maybe a bit less.” 6. What kind of vibe or tone works for you in advertising? “I prefer direct and honest. Like: “Make a bowl. No skills needed. We'll guide you.” That's enough to get me interested. I don't need a whole lifestyle pitch.” 7. Is there anything that would immediately make you say “no thanks” when looking at these kinds of events? “Yeah, if it seems too curated, like it's only for influencers or people who know how to take the perfect photo. I want to feel like it's okay to mess up and just enjoy the process.”
Interviewee 9: 19 years old female student, budget conscious but curious <i>“If it looks fun and I don't need to bring anything, I'm in.”</i>	1. Do you ever go to workshops or hands-on creative events in Prague? Why or why not? “I've done a few! Mostly through student groups. But I don't have the money to do things like that all the time. If it's cheap and not far, I'll go.” 2. If you were to look for something creative to do, where would you search first? “Instagram or maybe Google. But usually someone tells me about it, like a friend shares a story or post.” 3. What makes you trust or choose one provider over another? “If it's popular and has good comments or tags. And if the people who go don't all look the same. If I see a mix of students, girls, guys, even older people — that's a good sign.” 4. If you saw a creative workshop listed on Airbnb, would you be likely to try it? Or would you prefer to book directly? “I didn't even know locals could book on Airbnb! But sure, if it looked cool and was in English or Czech, I'd book there. Especially if it was easy and I could pay online, or ask my parents” 5. How much would you be willing to spend for a two hours hands-on experience (like painting or pottery)? “Max 500–800 CZK, unless it's something really special. Students don't have much money...” 6. What kind of vibe or tone works for you in advertising? “Fun and inviting. Like “come try it, no pressure.” If it says “for beginners” or “everyone's welcome,” that makes me feel more

	confident.” 7. Is there anything that would immediately make you say “no thanks” when looking at these kinds of events? “If it looks like it’s just for girls doing it for Instagram. Or if it seems expensive and too fancy. I want to see real people having fun, not just pretty content.”
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Appendix C: Texts for listing chocolate workshop on Airbnb Experience

Section “What you will do”

“Ready to slow down and make something sweet?

During this cozy 2 hour experience, you'll step into our sunlit art studio in the heart of Prague and learn how to make handcrafted chocolate using natural ingredients and your own creative flair, no experience needed! We want you to enjoy the process!

We'll start by melting high-quality Belgian chocolate and playing with different flavors and textures. You'll choose your own toppings (such as sea salt, dried berries, nuts or gold dust) and pour your mixture into shapes, creating totally custom chocolate bars or truffles.

While they cool, we'll chat over tea, and you'll decorate your gift box to take home (or snack on your creation right away — we won't judge!).

You do not need to bring anything, just yourself! This workshop is great for both individuals and groups, adults and children.

Sooo... at the end, you'll walk away with:

- a personalized box of handmade chocolates (a cool idea for a souvenir!)
- sweet memories
- and hopefully... chocolaty fingers

If you would like to visit us in a different time slot, let us know. We will check availability and add the slot for you:)

Section “Meet your host”

“I live in Prague and love working with my hands. I spend my days surrounded by colors, textures and people from all over the world. I'm someone who finds calm in slow things, like making something from scratch or sharing tea with a stranger.

Friends would say I'm warm and a little quirky (I do rearrange furniture just for fun). I'm not here to teach perfection! just to make sure you feel safe, welcome and proud of whatever you create."

Booking confirmation message

"Hi guest's name,

Thank you for booking! We're excited to welcome you to our chocolate workshop in Prague.

You're booked for:

Chocolate workshop for number of guests people

date at time

No need to bring anything, we'll provide all materials. Just come as you are!

The workshop takes place at the address. Make sure to arrive here 10-15 minutes early before we begin so that we can start on time.

We'll send you a quick reminder before the workshop day. If you need help with anything or have any questions before your visit, just message me anytime.

Can't wait to meet you!

Anna"

Feedback inquiry message

"Hi guest's name,

Thank you again for joining our chocolate workshop, your sea salt caramel swirls looked amazing! We loved having you here and hope your chocolates made it home safely (or didn't make it that far 😊).

If you enjoyed the experience, we'd be truly grateful for the quick 5-star review on Airbnb. Your feedback lets others find us and supports our small creative studio in a big way.

Something felt off or if there's anything we could improve? Please feel free to message me here. We always welcome honest feedback and want every guest to feel seen and appreciated.

Wishing you sweet memories and lots of future creative moments,

Anna"

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